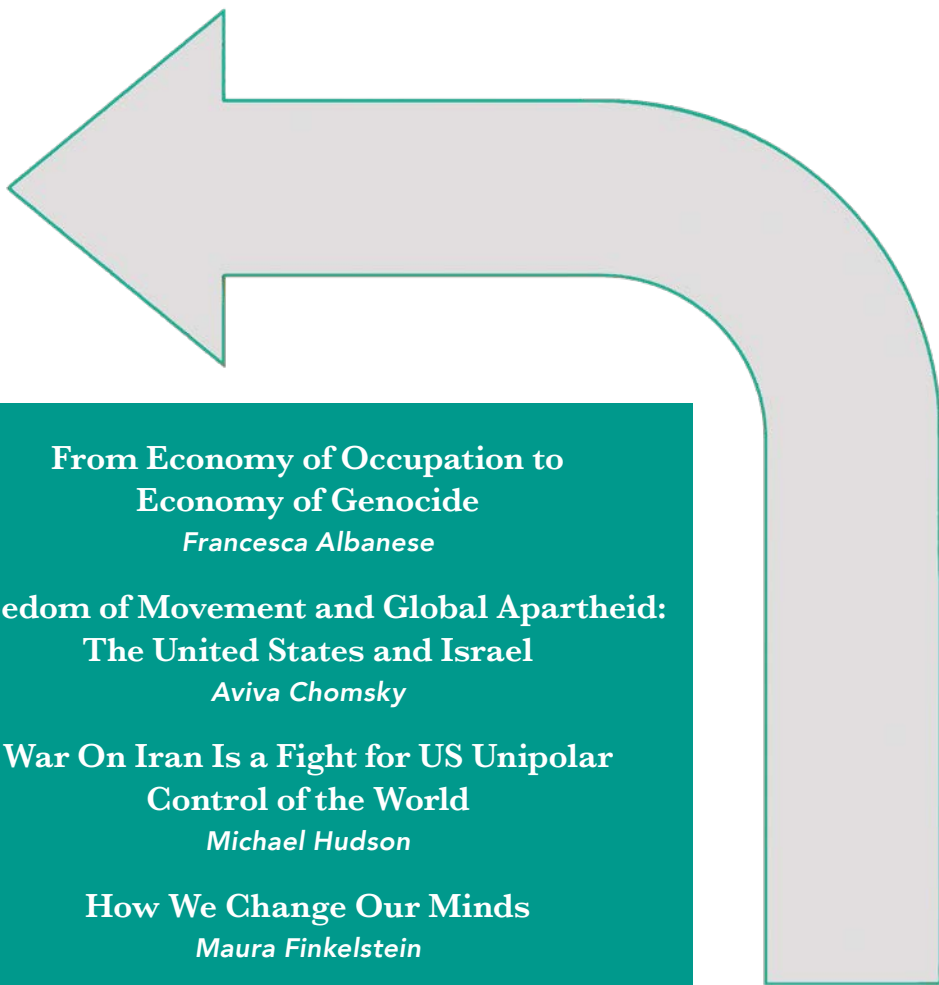


Left Turn

A Quarterly Journal of Critical Voices



**From Economy of Occupation to
Economy of Genocide**

Francesca Albanese

**Freedom of Movement and Global Apartheid:
The United States and Israel**

Aviva Chomsky

**War On Iran Is a Fight for US Unipolar
Control of the World**

Michael Hudson

How We Change Our Minds

Maura Finkelstein

Trump, Epstein, and the Deep State

Chris Hedges

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Notes from the Editors

(In this issue, we feature the following selected notes from [Gary Olson's Substack](#) and invite readers to subscribe to get full access to all the posts and updates.)

[<https://glolson.substack.com/>]

NATO plan to purchase US weapons is crumbling

On July 14, President Trump, seated next to NATO's chief Mark Rutte, announced that the EU would pay for US weapons to be shipped to support Project Ukraine. The proposal was news to some EU leaders who had not previously been briefed on the plan. The proposal then morphed into a NATO purchase and again, not all NATO members were consulted. Macron quickly opted out on the grounds that France wanted to boost its own arms industry. Italy, Spain and the Czech Republic all refused to write checks for the weapons, citing "budget constraints" as the reason. That leaves Germany, UK, the Netherlands and the four Nordic countries. Financial scandals and a struggling economy in Britain, staunch opposition among younger Germans, the need to debate the plan in various parliaments (which could take months) and the absence of any concrete purchase plan all point toward the eventual collapse of Trump's ill-conceived and vague initiative. Finally, leaving aside the question of whether the US even has enough of these weapons in the Pentagon's pantry is the fact that increased defense spending in various European countries will come at the expense of social programs and even hyping the phony "Russian threat" will make this a tough sale. Note: NATO was founded on April 4, 1949, to resist socialist and national liberation struggles across the globe and serve as a tool of US and European imperialism, the 1 percent of the 1 percent. Hopefully, ordinary citizens in Europe will begin taking the first steps toward its dissolution.

Epstein and GOP Contortions on Ukraine

House Republicans Voted Not to Release the Epstein files. Clearly, they (and Trump) want the matter to go away.

(continued on page 62)

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Contributed work does not necessarily represent the views of the Alliance.

From Economy of Occupation to Economy of Genocide

Editor's note: The following is taken from the report of the Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in the Palestinian territories occupied since 1967.

FRANCESCA ALBANESE

I. Introduction

1. Colonial endeavors and associated genocides have historically been driven and enabled by the corporate sector; commercial interests have contributed to the dispossession of Indigenous people of their lands—a mode of domination known as “colonial racial capitalism”. The same is true of Israeli colonization of Palestinian lands, its expansion into the occupied Palestinian territory, and its institutionalization of a regime of settler-colonial apartheid. After denying Palestinian self-determination for decades, Israel is now imperiling the very existence of the Palestinian people in Palestine.
2. The role of corporate entities in sustaining the illegal Israeli occupation and its ongoing genocidal campaign in Gaza is the subject of the present investigative report, which is focused on how corporate interests underpin the Israeli settler-colonial twofold logic of displacement and replacement aimed at dispossessing and erasing Palestinians from their lands. The Special Rapporteur discusses corporate entities in various sectors: arms manufacturers, tech firms, building and construction companies, extractive and service industries, banks, pension funds, insurers, universities, and charities. These entities enable the denial of self-determination and other structural violations in the occupied Palestinian territory, including occupation, annexation, and crimes of apartheid and genocide, as well as a long list of ancillary crimes and human rights violations, from discrimination, wanton destruction, forced displacement, and pillage to extrajudicial killing and starvation.
3. Had proper human rights due diligence been undertaken, corporate entities would have long ago disengaged from Israeli occupation. Instead, post-October 2023, corporate actors have contributed to the acceleration of the displacement-replacement process throughout the military campaign that has pulverized Gaza and displaced the largest number of Palestinians in the West Bank since 1967.
4. While it is impossible to fully capture the scale and extent of decades of corporate connivance in the exploitation of the occupied Palestinian territory, the present report exposes the integration of the economies of settler-colonial occupation and genocide. In it, the Special Rapporteur calls for accountability for corporate entities and their executives at both the domestic and international levels: commercial

endeavors enabling and profiting from the obliteration of innocent people's lives must cease. Corporate entities must refuse to be complicit in human rights violations and international crimes or be held to account.

* * *

IV. From the economy of settler-colonial occupation to the economy of genocide

22. Settler-colonialism involves extraction and profit from, and colonization of, land through the expulsion of its owners. In Palestine, historically, companies have driven and enabled the process of displacement and replacement of the Arab population, foundational to the logic of settler-colonial erasure. The Jewish National Fund, a land-purchasing corporate entity founded in 1901, helped plan and carry out the gradual removal of Arab Palestinians, which intensified with the Nakba and has continued ever since.
23. Increasingly aided by corporate entities, Israel has pursued Palestinian dispossession and displacement, especially after 1967. The corporate sector has materially contributed to this endeavor by providing Israel with the weapons and machinery required to destroy homes, schools, hospitals, places of leisure and worship, livelihoods and productive assets, such as olive groves and orchards, to segregate and control communities, and to restrict access to natural resources. By helping to militarize and incentivize illegal Israeli presence in the occupied Palestinian territory, the corporate sector has contributed to the creation of the conditions for Palestinian ethnic cleansing.
24. Corporate entities have played a key role in stifling the Palestinian economy, sustaining Israeli expansion in occupied land while facilitating the replacement of Palestinians. Draconian restrictions—on trade and investment, tree planting, fishing and water for colonies—have debilitated agriculture and industry and turned the occupied Palestinian territory into a captive market; companies have profiteered by exploiting Palestinian labor and resources, degrading and diverting natural resources, building and powering colonies and selling and marketing derived goods and services in Israel, the occupied Palestinian territory and globally. The Israeli-Palestinian Interim Agreement on the West Bank and the Gaza Strip (Oslo II Accords) entrenched this exploitation, de facto institutionalizing the monopoly of Israel over 61 per cent of the resource-rich West Bank (Area C). Israel gains from this exploitation, while it costs the Palestinian economy at least 35 per cent of its GDP.
25. Financial and academic institutions have also enabled the conditions for Palestinian displacement and replacement. Banks, asset management firms, pension funds, and insurers have channeled finance into the illegal occupation. Universities—centers of intellectual growth and power—have sustained the political ideology underpinning the colonization of Palestinian land, developed weaponry, and overlooked or even endorsed systemic violence, while global research collaborations have obscured Palestinian erasure behind a veil of academic neutrality.

26. After October 2023, long-standing systems of control, exploitation, and dispossession metamorphosed into economic, technological, and political infrastructures mobilized to inflict mass violence and immense destruction. Entities that previously enabled and profited from Palestinian elimination and erasure within the economy of occupation, instead of disengaging, are now involved in the economy of genocide.
27. The following sections [in the full report] illustrate how eight key sectors, operating separately and interdependently through the core pillars of the settler-colonial economy of displacement and replacement, have adapted to its genocidal practices.

* * *

V. Conclusions

87. While life in Gaza is being obliterated and the West Bank is under escalating assault, the present report shows why the genocide carried out by Israel continues: because it is lucrative for many. By shedding light on the political economy of an occupation turned genocidal, the report reveals how the forever-occupation has become the ideal testing ground for arms manufacturers and big tech—providing boundless supply and demand, little oversight, and zero accountability—while investors and private and public institutions profit freely. Too many influential corporate entities remain inextricably financially bound to Israeli apartheid and militarism.
88. Post-October 2023, as the Israeli defense budget has doubled, and at a time of falling demand, production, and consumer confidence, an international network of corporations has propped up the Israeli economy. Blackrock and Vanguard rank among the largest investors in arms companies pivotal to the genocidal arsenal of Israel. Major global banks have underwritten Israeli treasury bonds, which have bankrolled the devastation, and the largest sovereign wealth and pension funds invested public and private savings in the genocidal economy, all the while claiming to respect ethical guidelines.
89. Arms companies have turned over near record profits by equipping Israel with cutting-edge weaponry that has devastated a virtually defenseless civilian population. The machinery of global construction equipment giants has been instrumental in razing Gaza to the ground, preventing the return and reconstitution of Palestinian life. Extractive energy and mining conglomerates, while providing sources of civilian energy, have fueled the military and energy infrastructures of Israel—both of which are used to create conditions of life calculated to destroy the Palestinian people.
90. And while the genocide rages on, the inexorable process of violent annexation in the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, continues. Agribusiness still sustains the expansion of the settlement enterprise. The largest online tourism platforms continue normalizing the illegality of Israeli colonies. Global supermarkets continue to stock Israeli settlement products. And universities worldwide, under the guise of research neutrality, continue to profit from an economy now operating

in genocidal mode. Indeed, they are structurally dependent on settler-colonial collaborations and funding.

91. Business continues as usual, but nothing about this system, in which businesses are integral, is neutral. The enduring ideological, political, and economic engine of racial capitalism has transformed the Israeli displacement-replacement economy of occupation into an economy of genocide. This is a “joint criminal enterprise”, where the acts of one ultimately contribute to a whole economy that drives, supplies, and enables this genocide.
92. The entities named in the present report constitute a fraction of a much deeper structure of corporate involvement, profiteering from and enabling violations and crimes in the occupied Palestinian territory. Had they exercised due diligence, corporate entities would have ceased involvement with Israel long ago. Today, the demand for accountability is all the more urgent: any investment sustains a system of serious international crimes.
93. Business and human rights obligations cannot be isolated from the Israeli illegal settler-colonial enterprise in the occupied Palestinian territory, which now functions as a genocidal machine, despite the International Court of Justice having ordered that it be fully and unconditionally dismantled. Corporate relations with Israel must cease until the occupation and apartheid end and reparations are made. The corporate sector, including its executives, must be held to account, as a necessary step towards ending the genocide and disassembling the global system of racialized capitalism that underpins it.

VI. Recommendations

94. The Special Rapporteur urges Member States:
- (a) To impose sanctions and a full arms embargo on Israel, including all existing agreements and dual-use items such as technology and civilian heavy machinery;
 - (b) To suspend or prevent all trade agreements and investment relations, and impose sanctions, including asset freezes, on entities and individuals involved in activities that may endanger the Palestinians;
 - (c) To enforce accountability, ensuring that corporate entities face legal consequences for their involvement in serious violations of international law.
95. The Special Rapporteur urges corporate entities:
- (a) To promptly cease all business activities and terminate relationships directly linked with, contributing to, and causing human rights violations and international crimes against the Palestinian people, in accordance with international corporate responsibilities and the law of self-determination;
 - (b) To pay reparations to the Palestinian people, including in the form of an apartheid wealth tax along the lines of post-apartheid South Africa.
96. The Special Rapporteur urges the International Criminal Court and national judiciaries to investigate and prosecute corporate executives and/or corporate entities for their part in the commission of international crimes and laundering of the proceeds from those crimes.

97. The Special Rapporteur urges the United Nations:
- (a) To comply with the International Court of Justice advisory opinion of 2024;
 - (b) To include all entities involved in Israeli unlawful occupation in the OHCHR [Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights] database (to be properly accessible on the [OHCHR website](#)).
98. The Special Rapporteur urges trade unions, lawyers, civil society, and ordinary citizens to press for boycotts, divestments, sanctions, justice for Palestine, and accountability at the international and domestic levels; together, the people of the world can end these unspeakable crimes.
99. The present report is written at the cusp of a profound and tumultuous transformation. Globally witnessed atrocities require urgent accountability and justice, which demand diplomatic, economic, and legal action against those who have maintained and profited from an economy of occupation turned genocidal. What comes next depends on everyone.

Francesca Paola Albanese is an Italian legal scholar and expert on human rights. Since 2022 she has served as the United Nations Special Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in the occupied Palestinian territories occupied since 1967.

Editor's note: In a sane society, Francesca would be a strong candidate for the Nobel Peace Prize. Alas. On July 9, the Rogue State Par Excellence, globally known as the US, announced sanctions against Francesca Albanese. She "has spewed unabashed antisemitism, expressed support for terrorism, and open contempt for the United States, Israel, and the West," stated the State Department without any shame. The US Secretary of State Marco Rubio joined in, stating on his X account: "We will always stand by our partners in their right to self-defense." The depth of depravity is stunning. No one should waste their time waiting for the Democrats or the mainstream media to expose this depravity, let alone oppose it; they, too, are part of the problem.

Freedom of Movement and Global Apartheid: The United States and Israel

AVIVA CHOMSKY

In an aphorism sometimes attributed to Leo Tolstoy, sometimes to John Gardner, all literature relies on one of two plots: a person goes on a journey or a stranger comes to town.

Let me offer my own version. We might summarize the entire history of the human race in two words: people move. Everything else is just elaboration on that basic plot.

Some of history's worst atrocities can be attributed to certain people trying to control other people's movements, whether by capturing them, herding them into prison camps (concentration camps, strategic hamlets, model villages), enslaving and transporting them, or warehousing them in besieged countries or regions while barricading the borders of anyplace to which they might want to flee, often consigning them to death in treacherous deserts or seas for trying to exercise the basic human right of freedom of movement.

European Freedom and Colonial Domination

In February, President Trump astonished the world by proclaiming that the United States should "take over" Gaza and rid it entirely of its Palestinian population. Yet in many ways, as startling as that might have seemed, his proposal fit right in with his drive to remove millions of people from the United States. Both reflected a colonial arrogance that the U.S. and Israel share: the idea that some people (Americans/Europeans/Whites/colonizers) have the right to move themselves as they desire while moving others against their will. Consider it, after a fashion, a contemporary (as well as historic) version of apartheid.

Forcing people to move or prohibiting their mobility are two sides of the same colonial or neocolonial coin. Colonizers invade and drive people out or enslave, transport, enclose, and imprison them while barricading off the privileged spaces they create for themselves. In a vicious cycle, colonizers or imperial powers justify their borders and walls in the name of "security" while protecting themselves from those desperate to escape their domination. And such ideas, old as they may be, are still distinctly with us.

European imperial actors from Christopher Columbus on claimed the right to freedom of movement on this planet. Today, the flyer you get in the mail with your passport proudly insists that, "with your U.S. passport, the world is yours!"

Or consider historian and scientist Jared Diamond's nonchalant claim that "no traditional society tolerated the relatively open access enjoyed by modern American or European citizens, most of whom can travel anywhere... merely by presenting a valid passport and visa to a passport control officer."

Diamond argued that Americans and Europeans exemplify the freedoms of modernity, while more “traditional societies” oppress people by restricting their travel. But if Americans and Europeans enjoy the freedom to travel, it’s not because they are so much more modern than other inhabitants of this planet. It’s because other countries don’t restrict their freedom. On the other hand, it’s the U.S. and Europe, Diamond’s symbols of modernity, that tend to impose the greatest restrictions with their militarized borders and deportation regimes.

Perhaps we could better define modernity as the European drive to control mobility, forcing others to accept their intrusions while denying free mobility to the rest of the world. The United States and Israel offer a spectrum of examples of how the right to deport, the right to transport, the right to enclose, and the right to exclude tend to complement one another on this strange planet of ours. Both countries claim to be liberal democracies and celebrate their commitment to equal rights, while reserving those rights for some and excluding others.

Colonialism and the Postwar Order

While it’s easy to imagine that colonialism is part of our past, think again. Its structures, institutions, and ideas still haunt our world. And one of the defining powers of colonizers always was the way they reserved for themselves (and only themselves) the right to move freely, while also reserving the right to move those they had colonized around like so many chess pieces.

Moving (and moving others) has been inherent in every colonial project. The roots of today’s deportation regimes—particularly in the United States, Europe, and Israel—lie in the determination of colonializing countries to wrest wealth from the lands and labor of those they colonized and enjoy that wealth in their own privileged spaces from which the colonized are largely excluded.

The “rules-based world order” that emerged after World War II created institutions for international cooperation and international law, ended colonial empires (as the former colonies gained independence), and dismantled segregation in the United States and, eventually, apartheid in South Africa. But none of that truly or totally erased what had existed before. Global postwar decolonization and the struggle for equality proved to be lengthy and sometimes extremely bloody processes.

In the U.S., people of color are full citizens and can no longer, as a group, be legally enclosed or removed against their will. Europe, too, has dismantled its colonial empires. But the post-colonial world has developed a new form of global apartheid, where the racialized drive to enclose and remove is now directed at immigrants, the vast majority of them escaping the ongoing ravages left by colonialism (and more recently climate change) in their own countries.

Israel is in some ways an anachronism in that twentieth-century trajectory. Its colonizing project was carried out just as other colonized peoples were throwing off their rulers. Its expulsions of Palestinians, which began in the 1940s, have only accelerated in our own time. Meanwhile, Israel created its own legal version of apartheid (even as South Africa’s was dismantled), with those Palestinians who were not expelled increasingly surrounded by prisons and walls.

The Right to Deport: Israel

Zionists began to assert the right to expel well before the state of Israel was created in 1948.

In 1895, in an often-quoted passage, Zionism’s founder, Theodor Herzl, proposed that “we shall try to spirit the penniless [Arab] population across the border... The removal of the poor must be carried out discreetly and circumspectly.” During the post-World War I British Mandate in Palestine, Zionist, Arab, and British officials agreed that “there could be no viable Jewish state in all or part of Palestine unless there was a mass displacement of Arab inhabitants.”

Palestine’s British colonial authorities advocated such a displacement in their 1937 Peel Commission Report. It was then enthusiastically endorsed by Zionist leaders like David Ben-Gurion, later Israel’s first prime minister (“The compulsory transfer of the Arabs from the valleys of the proposed Jewish state could give us... an opportunity which we never dared to dream in our wildest imaginings”) and Chaim Weizmann (“If half a million Arabs could be transferred, two million Jews could be put in their place”).

Israel compounded its right to deport with the right to imprison, enclose, and kill. A plethora of laws and walls continue to restrict the return, movement, and residence of Palestinians. Israeli historian Ilan Pappé described the Israeli occupation regime in the West Bank and Gaza since 1967 as having created “the biggest prison on earth.”

In the older settler colonial countries, the days of Trails of Tears, imprisonment on reservations, the forced removal of children to boarding schools, and wars of extermination are mostly in the past. But in Israel, we are witnessing such a project happening before our very eyes. The eliminationist project there is proceeding apace with the tens of thousands killed in Gaza, and in President Trump’s and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s bald proposals for the complete removal of the Palestinian population from that strip of land, as well as in the restrictions on mobility and the thousands of home demolitions and displacements in the West Bank and East Jerusalem.

The Right to Deport: The United States

In the United States during the nineteenth and twentieth centuries, this country ended slavery and enclosure and granted previously enslaved Africans and their descendants, as well as Native Americans, the right to citizenship.

Until after the Civil War, however, “immigrants” meant White Europeans—the only people then allowed to become citizens. Citizenship by birth, mandated by the 14th Amendment after the Civil War, complicated that picture because non-Whites born in U.S. territories also became citizens. To avoid this, the country quickly began to racially restrict immigration. By the late twentieth century, the right to immigrate and more equal rights inside the country were extended to non-Whites. But those rights were always fragile and accompanied by anti-immigrant and deportation campaigns, increasingly justified with the concept of “illegality.”

Developments in the twenty-first century clearly suggest that the arc of history does not necessarily bend toward justice, as a racial deportation regime resurges

in a major fashion under President Donald Trump. He, of course, has long distinguished between “shithole countries” and “countries like Norway” as he continues to tighten the screws around most immigrants from Africa, Asia, and Latin America, while recently ostentatiously welcoming White Afrikaners from South Africa.

The Trump administration’s repressive treatment of immigrants includes endless border militarization, the stripping of legal status from hundreds of thousands of immigrants, inventing increasingly draconian excuses for deportation, expanding immigrant incarceration, and pursuing exotic extraterritorial imprisonment and deportation schemes, including pressuring and bribing countries ranging from Costa Rica and Venezuela to Libya and South Sudan to take people forcibly deported from the United States. Others are being disappeared into prisons in Guantánamo and El Salvador.

Strangely—or maybe not so strangely—at the same time that the United States is deporting such “despicable human beings,” it’s demanding the extradition of others, including dozens of Mexicans. “The previous Administration allowed these criminals to run free and commit crimes all over the world,” Trump complained. “The United States’ intention is to extend its justice system,” a Mexican security analyst explained, so that the U.S. can prosecute Mexicans for crimes committed in Mexico. Forcibly moving people works both ways.

Connecting the U.S. and Israel Through Importation—Deportation

The colonial importation-deportation-incarceration regimes of the United States and Israel are intertwined in many ways. Of course, the U.S. decision to strictly limit Jewish (and other southern and eastern European) immigration in the 1920s contributed to the desperate search of European Jews for refuge in the Hitlerian years to come—and to the growth of Zionism, and the postwar migration to Israel.

The new United Nations—made up primarily of colonizers who had been keen to deport (or, in the case of the United States, make sure they didn’t add to) their own Jewish populations—partitioned Palestine to create Israel at the end of 1947. As the only powerful country to emerge from World War II unscathed, the United States would play an outsized role in that organization.

President Trump’s proposal to take Gaza and eliminate its population expresses his own (and Israel’s) settler-colonial dream for what Australian anthropologist Patrick Wolfe famously called the “elimination of the native.” Trump initially suggested deporting Gaza’s population to Egypt and Jordan, then to Sudan, Somalia, and Somaliland, and then to Libya—proposals enthusiastically endorsed by Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu. By mid-March of this year, Israel was creating a new migration authority to oversee the planned expulsion and 80% of Jewish Israelis found that plan “desirable” (though only 52% thought it was “practical”).

As of late May, none of those countries had accepted Trump’s proposal, though negotiations with Libya were evidently ongoing. But Trump’s plan to pressure or bribe poorer, weaker countries to accept Palestinian deportees mirrored his deals to deport “unwanted” from the United States. In addition to the several Latin American countries where his administration has already sent deportees, it is looking to Angola, Benin, Equatorial Guinea, Eswatini, Libya, Moldova, and Rwanda as possibilities. As Secretary of State Marco Rubio explained, “We are working with other

countries to say, ‘we want to send you some of the most despicable human beings to your countries... Would you do that, as a favor to us? And the further away from America, the better.’”

Another connection between the deportation regimes of the U.S. and Israel is the way the Trump administration has mobilized charges of antisemitism to imprison and deport Palestinians and their supporters. In ordering the deportation of protester Mahmoud Khalil and others, Rubio claimed that their “condoning antisemitic conduct” undermined American foreign policy objectives.

The United States and Israel share another dystopian project as well: ratcheting up fear and suffering to inspire people to “self-deport.” Department of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem flooded social and other media with a “multimillion dollar ad campaign” threatening immigrants: “Leave now. If you don’t, we will find you and we will deport you.” In this respect, MAGA Republicans differed little from liberal Democrats, as Noem was echoing Vice President Kamala Harris’s words to Guatemalans: “Don’t come... If you do, you will be turned back.” In an eerily similar fashion, on the Israeli-occupied West Bank, “settler advertisements appear on screens and billboards telling Palestinians, ‘There is no future in Palestine.’” Though their tactics differ in scale—the United States is not massacring immigrants and bombing their neighborhoods—they share the goal of eliminating a population.

One apparent difference makes the comparison even more revealing. The United States is aiming its repression at immigrants; Israel against the native population. But the earliest history of deportation in the United States began with the pushing out or slaughtering of the indigenous Native American population in order to clear the land for White settlement. Meanwhile, hundreds of thousands of Africans were forcibly imported to provide labor, many of them even before the U.S. became an independent state. They then remained enslaved and their mobility restricted for almost a century. Colonial control of freedom of movement, in other words, can take different forms over time.

Both the United States and Israel also disproportionately imprison their minoritized populations—another denial of freedom of movement. In the United States, this means people of color. Black people make up 14% of the population but 41% of the prison and jail population. Native Americans are incarcerated at four times the rate of White people. The United States also maintains the world’s largest immigrant detention system, with expansion plans already underway.

In Israel, it’s Palestinians who are disproportionately imprisoned, both inside that country and in its occupied territories. While Palestinians constitute about 20% of Israel’s population, they constitute about 60% of Israel’s prisoners. (Such statistics are hard to come by today, so that figure doesn’t include the thousands taken prisoner since Oct. 7, 2023.) Many Palestinian prisoners languish in what Israel calls “administrative detention,” a status created for Palestinians that allows lengthy detention without charge.

Borders, Walls, and Global Apartheid

We are so accustomed to imagining a world of equally sovereign countries, each creating its own immigration policy, that it’s easy to miss the colonial dimensions

of immigration flows and the ways that colonial histories, immigration restrictions, expulsions, and incarceration are connected. Settler countries like Israel and the United States have particular similarities (and particular connections), but most European powers that have benefited from the world's colonial order now barricade their borders against potential migrants.

Most of the world agrees that apartheid inside a country's borders is the epitome of injustice. Why, then, are we so ready to accept a global version of it?

This essay initially appeared on tomdispatch.com on June 10, 2025.

*Aviva Chomsky is a professor of history and coordinator of Latin American studies at Salem State University in Massachusetts. Her most recent book is *Is Science Enough? Forty Critical Questions about Climate Justice*.*

Opposition to the US/Israel is going mainstream. Next, they will have you forget about their nearly two-year-long complicity and/or silence in this century's worst ongoing atrocity. They will soon claim that they opposed it from the start.
Don't Forget, Don't Forgive.

—Faramarz Farbod

Israel's Genocidal Intentions Have Been Obvious This Whole Time

CAITLIN JOHNSTONE

Liberal Israelis are slowly [beginning](#) to join the rest of the world in [admitting](#) that what's happening in Gaza [is a genocide](#)—a fact that has been clear to anyone with eyes and a basic sense of morality from the very beginning of this nightmare.

It was obvious in October 2023 that Israel intended to eliminate all Palestinians in Gaza, in part because you would never treat a population that way if you intended to leave survivors on your border. Because you'd know they'd seek revenge later on.

Call it the [Inigo Montoya](#) problem—if you kill someone's father right in front of him, it's a safe bet that he's going to spend the rest of his life trying to kill you. If you intend to act in monstrous ways that fill young children with thoughts of revenge, then you need to get rid of the children, and you need to get rid of the women who will give birth to them. Otherwise you're just creating a problem for your own children and grandchildren down the road.

The Nazis understood this. Heinrich Himmler famously said, “I did not feel I had a right to exterminate the men—i.e. kill them or have them killed—while allowing the children to grow up and take revenge upon our sons and grandsons. We had to reach the difficult decision of making this nation vanish from the face of the earth.”

The savagery of Israel's post-October 7 onslaught was so horrific right off the bat that it was clear they didn't intend to leave anyone alive in Gaza. It was clear they intended to kill as many people as possible and force any survivors to leave, because there's no way they'd be acting with such sadistic bloodlust if they had any plans to leave survivors within striking distance of themselves.

And that is exactly how it has played out. They've intentionally turned Gaza into an uninhabitable wasteland while creating a waking nightmare of death and unfathomable suffering, and Trump and Netanyahu [are openly saying](#) that it's not going to end until all the Palestinians have been removed one way or another.

If you're going to rape and torture a child, you probably don't intend to then drop them off at the nearest hospital when you are done with them, because you know the police will be at your door the next day. If you're going to murder your enemy's wife and kids in front of him, you probably don't intend to leave him alive to seek revenge at a later date. Once you've gone all-in on perpetrating a sufficiently terrible act, you often need to do some extra killing on top of it to protect yourself from the consequences of your actions.

That's one of the many reasons why it has always been clear that Israel's intentions for Gaza are genocide and ethnic cleansing. Even if Israeli officials hadn't been making openly genocidal statements, and even if genocidal sentiments hadn't been proliferating throughout the collective consciousness of apartheid Israel for many years—hell, even if you knew absolutely nothing about Israel and Palestine and just looked at the reality on the ground in Gaza—it would still have been obvious to you

that Israel did not intend to leave any of those people there. Just because of where they were located and how Israel was treating them.

So when people claim at this late date that they are coming to the reluctant conclusion that Israel is committing genocide in Gaza, I have a hard time believing them. It was obvious to anyone with a basic understanding of human nature that Israel had no intention of leaving any survivors of this mass atrocity on its border. People are just covering their own asses and trying to wash their hands of their guilt for their complicity in a 21st century holocaust over the past 22 months.

*Caitlin Johnstone is a reader-funded journalist, essayist, painter, and poet in Melbourne, Australia, and the author of the illustrated poetry book *Woke: A Field Guide For Utopia Preppers**

This piece first appeared in [Caitlin Johnstone's website](#) on November 5, 2024.

“It’s not okay to be a grown adult with internet access in August 2025 and still believe that this mass atrocity is about hostages, or is about Hamas, or is about October 7, or is about anything besides the long-sought agenda to remove Palestinians from a Palestinian territory.”

Caitlin Johnstone

Remarks at a Rally Against the Attacks on Iran

ELAHEH FARMAND

Editor’s note: Elaheh made these remarks at the June 26 rally against the Israel and US attacks on Iran in Bethlehem, PA.

Like many immigrants from the West Asia, today I am processing grief. The grief, shock, and outrage as I watched Israel and the US bomb Iran, my birth country. Iran, whose language and songs I speak and sing proudly. Iran, who has been meddled with too many times by Western powers. Iran, whose people are tired of fighting to break free. Iran, whose voices have been repressed too many times, including by their own leaders.

I am a daughter of war. I was born in Tehran in 1987 at the tail end of the eight-year Iraq-Iran war. While I don’t have memories tainted by war, my family does. My family knows the sounds of bombs, and the warnings beforehand, as they hurried their way down to bomb shelters. They know how to be ready to flee quickly, bags packed, eyes alert. They know the feeling in their stomachs, when the skies light up with missiles, and the destruction that follows.

In the US, when my family hears sirens, their hearts race and fear takes over. For immigrants in the US, sirens and fireworks are a reminder of danger—the danger they had hoped to escape when they left their homelands, often as their last option.

All of us here like to believe that we are safe, but safety is an illusion in an empire that prides itself on the mightiest military and uses military force on its own citizens. We manufacture weapons of mass destruction right here, but we go to war with brown people in the West Asia, falsely accusing them of having weapons of mass destruction.

The puppets in power tell us that we are at war to liberate the people of Iran. They said the same about Libya, about Iraq, about Afghanistan. When have US bombs and missiles ever liberated a people? By now we have all witnessed in horror what our bombs, signed proudly by our congresspeople, do to our brothers and sisters in Palestine.

To the few in power, this is all a game show. We are the actors in an absurd, tragic comedy. The question is, will we the people rewrite this script?

I believe that we will. I choose hope over despair. I choose love over hate. Let us show up with love and compassion for our communities, our neighbors, our children. Let us unite together with love as we stand against masked agents breaking up our immigrant communities. Whether in the streets, in our homes or workplaces, let us be kinder to one another and show these puppets that they cannot divide us. For a people united can never be defeated.

Elaheh Farmand is an Iranian immigrant and writer. In 2016, she founded the series, “Immigrants & Exile: Stories of Nostalgia & Longing”. The series gives space for people to share their experiences of nostalgia, exile, and longing. Elaheh fights for and dreams of a society restructured to place people’s needs and wellbeing before profits. She is occasionally nostalgic for her childhood in Iran, but focuses her energy on organizing, connecting with her community, her family and friends.

War On Iran Is a Fight for US Unipolar Control of the World

Preempting dollar hegemony exit, disrupting Eurasian integration with China & Russia

MICHAEL HUDSON



US President Donald Trump speaks to the media at the White House, 27 June 2025.
Photo credit: Ken Cedeno

Opponents of the war with Iran say that the war is not in American interests, seeing that Iran does not pose any visible threat to the United States.

This appeal to reason misses the neoconservative logic that has guided US foreign policy for more than half a century, and which is now threatening to engulf the Middle East in the most violent war since Korea.

That logic is so aggressive, so repugnant to most people, and so much in violation of the basic principles of international law, the United Nations, and the US Constitution, that there is an understandable shyness on the part of the authors of this strategy to spell out what is at stake.

What is at stake is the US attempt to control the Middle East and its oil as a buttress of US economic power, and to prevent other countries from moving to create their own autonomy from the US-centered neoliberal order administered by the IMF, World Bank, and other institutions to reinforce US unipolar power.

The 1970s saw much discussion about creating a [New International Economic Order](#) (NIEO). US strategists saw this as a threat, and since my book, *Super Imperialism*, ironically was used as something like a textbook by the government, I was invited to comment on how I thought countries would break away from US control.

I was working at the Hudson Institute with Herman Kahn, and in 1974 or 1975, he brought me to sit in on a military strategy discussion of plans that were already being made at that time to possibly overthrow Iran and break it up into ethnic parts. Herman found the weakest spot to be Baluchistan, on Iran's border with Pakistan.

The Kurds, Tajiks, and Turkic Azeris were others whose ethnicities were to be played off against each other, giving US diplomacy a key potential client dictatorship to reshape both Iranian and Pakistani political orientation if need be.

Three decades later, in 2003, General Wesley Clark pointed to Iran as being the capstone of [seven countries that the United States needed to control](#) in order to dominate the Middle East, starting with Iraq, Syria, Lebanon, Libya, Somalia, and Sudan, culminating in Iran.

The US fight for unipolar control of the world

Most of today's discussion of the geopolitical dynamics of how the international economy is changing is understandably (and rightly) focusing on the attempt by BRICS and other countries to escape from US control by de-dollarizing their trade and investment.

But the most active dynamic presently reshaping the international economy has been the attempts of Donald Trump's whirlwind presidency since January to lock other countries into a US-centered economy, by agreeing not to focus their trade and investment on China and other states seeking autonomy from US control. (Trade with Russia is already heavily sanctioned.)

As will be described below, the war in Iran likewise has as an aim blocking trade with China and Russia and countering moves away from the US-centered neoliberal order.

Trump, hoping in his own self-defeating way to rebuild US industry, expected that countries would respond to his threat to create tariff chaos by reaching an agreement with America not to trade with China, and indeed to accept US trade and financial sanctions against it, Russia, Iran, and other countries deemed to be a threat to the unipolar US global order.

Maintaining that order is the US objective in its current fight with Iran, as well as its fights with Russia and China—and Cuba, Venezuela, and other countries seeking to restructure their economic policies to recover their independence.

From the view of US strategists, the rise of China poses an existential danger to US unipolar control, both as a result of China's industrial and trade dominance outstripping the US economy and threatening its markets and the dollarized global financial system, and by [China's industrial socialism](#) providing a model that other countries might seek to emulate and/or join with to recover the national sovereignty that has been eroded in recent decades.

US administrations and a host of US cold warriors have framed the issue as being between “democracy” (defined as countries supporting US policy as client regimes and oligarchies) and “autocracy” (countries seeking national self-reliance and protection from foreign trade and financial dependency).

This framing of the international economy views not only China but any other country seeking national autonomy as an existential threat to US unipolar domination. That attitude explains the US/NATO attack on Russia that has resulted in the Ukraine war of attrition, and most recently the US/Israeli war against Iran that is threatening to engulf the whole world in US-backed war.

The motivation for the attack on Iran has nothing to do with any attempt by Iran to protect its national sovereignty by developing an atom bomb. The basic problem is that the United States has taken the initiative in trying to preempt Iran and other countries from breaking away from dollar hegemony and US unipolar control.

Here's how the neocons spell out the US national interest in overthrowing the Iranian government and bringing about a regime change—not necessarily a secular democratic regime change, but perhaps an extension of the ISIS/Al-Qaida Wahhabi terrorists who have taken over Syria.

With Iran broken up and its component parts turned into a set of client oligarchies, US diplomacy can control all Middle Eastern oil. And control of oil has been a cornerstone of US international economic power for a century, thanks to US oil companies operating internationally (not only as domestic US producers of oil and gas) and remitting economic rents extracted from overseas to make a major contribution to the US balance of payments.

Control of Middle Eastern oil also enables the dollar diplomacy that has seen Saudi Arabia and other OPEC countries invest their oil revenues into the US economy by accumulating vast holdings of US Treasury securities and private-sector investments.

The United States holds OPEC countries hostage through these investments in the US economy (and in other Western economies), which can be expropriated much as the United States grabbed \$300 billion of Russia's monetary savings in the West in 2022. This largely explains why these countries are afraid to act in support of the Palestinians or Iranians in today's conflict.

But Iran is not only the capstone to full control of the Near East and its oil and dollar holdings. Iran is a key link for China's Belt and Road Initiative for a New Silk Road of railway transport to the West.

If the United States can overthrow the Iranian government, this interrupts the long transportation corridor that China already has constructed and hopes to extend further west.



Iran also is a key to blocking Russian trade and development via the Caspian Sea and access to the south, bypassing the Suez Canal. And under US control, an Iranian client regime could threaten Russia from its southern flank.

To the neocons, all this makes Iran a central pivot on which the US national interest is based—if you define that national interest as creating a coercive empire of client states observing dollar hegemony by adhering to the dollarized international financial system.

I think that [Trump's warning to Tehran's citizens to evacuate their city](#) is just an attempt to stir up domestic panic as a prelude to a US attempt to mobilize ethnic opposition as a means to break up Iran into component parts. It is similar to the US hopes to break up Russia and China into regional ethnicities.

That is the US strategic hope for a new international order that remains under its command.

← Truth Details

7592 replies

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Iran should have signed the "deal" I told them to sign. What a shame, and waste of human life. Simply stated, IRAN CAN NOT HAVE A NUCLEAR WEAPON. I said it over and over again! Everyone should immediately evacuate Tehran!

13.9k ReTruths 61.8k Likes

Jun 17, 2025, 6:30 AM

The irony, of course, is that US attempts to hold onto its fading economic empire continue to be self-defeating.

The objective is to control other nations by threatening economic chaos. But it is this US threat of chaos that is driving other nations to seek alternatives elsewhere. And an objective is not a strategy.

The plan to use Netanyahu as America's counterpart to Ukraine's Zelensky, demanding US intervention with his willingness to fight to the last Israeli, much as the US/NATO are fighting to the last Ukrainian, is a tactic that is quite obviously at the expense of strategy.

It is a warning to the entire world to find an escape hatch.

Like the US trade and financial sanctions intended to keep other countries dependent on US markets and a dollarized international financial system, the attempt to impose a military empire from Central Europe to the Middle East is politically self-destructive.

It is making the split that already is occurring between the US-centered neoliberal order and the Global Majority irreversible on moral grounds, as well as on the grounds of simple self-preservation and economic self-interest.

Trump's Republican budget plan and its vast increase in military spending

The ease with which Iranian missiles have been able to penetrate Israel's much-vaunted Iron Dome defense shows the folly of Trump's pressure for an enormous tril-

lion-dollar subsidy to the US military-industrial complex for a similar Golden Dome boondoggle here in the United States.

So far, the Iranians have used only their oldest and least effective missiles. The aim is to deplete Israel's anti-missile defenses so that in a few weeks it will be unable to block a serious Iranian attack.

Iran already demonstrated its ability to evade Israel's air defenses a few months ago, just as during Trump's previous presidency it showed how easily it could hit US military bases.

The US military budget actually is much larger than is reported in the proposed bill before Congress to approve Trump's trillion-dollar subsidy.

Congress funds its military-industrial complex (MIC) in two ways: The obvious way is by arms purchases paid for by Congress directly. Less acknowledged is MIC spending routed via US foreign military aid to its allies—Ukraine, Israel, Europe, South Korea, Japan, and other Asian countries—to buy US arms.

This explains why the military burden is what normally accounts for the entire US budget deficit and hence the rise in government debt (much of it self-financed via the Federal Reserve since 2008, to be sure).

The need for alternative international organizations

Unsurprisingly, the international community has been unable to prevent the US/Israeli war against Iran.

The United Nations Security Council is blocked by the United States' veto, and that of Britain and France, from taking measures against acts of aggression by the United States and its allies.

The United Nations is now seen to have become toothless and irrelevant as a world organization able to enforce international law. (Its situation is much as Stalin remarked regarding Vatican opposition, "How many troops does the Pope have?")

Just as the World Bank and International Monetary Fund are instruments of US foreign policy and control, so too are many other international organizations which are dominated by the United States and its allies, including (relevantly for today's crisis in West Asia) the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), that Iran has accused of having provided Israel targeting information for its attack on Iranian nuclear scientists and sites.

Breaking free of the US unipolar order requires a full spectrum set of alternative international organizations independent of the United States, NATO, and other client allies.

Trump's attack on Iran

The sound and fury of Trump's missile attack on Iran's most famous nuclear sites on June 21 turned out not to be the capstone of America's conquest of the Middle East. But it did more than signify nothing.

Trump must have listened to the military's warnings that all game plans for conflict with Iran at this time showed the United States losing badly.

His Trumpian solution was to [brag on his social media account](#) that he had won a great victory in stopping Iran's march toward making an atom bomb.

Iran for its part evidently was glad to cooperate with the public relations charade. The US missiles seem to have landed on mutually agreed-upon sites that Iran had vacated for just such a diplomatic stand-down.

← Truth Details
6628 replies

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We have completed our very successful attack on the three Nuclear sites in Iran, including Fordow, Natanz, and Esfahan. All planes are now outside of Iran air space. A full payload of BOMBS was dropped on the primary site, Fordow. All planes are safely on their way home. Congratulations to our great American Warriors. There is not another military in the World that could have done this. NOW IS THE TIME FOR PEACE! Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Trump always announces any act as a great victory, and in a way, it was, over the hopes and goading of his most ardent neoconservative advisors. The United States has deferred its hopes for conquest for the time being.

The fight is now to be limited to Iran and Israel. And [Israel has already offered to stop hostilities](#) if Iran does. Iran gave hope for an armistice once it had exacted due retaliation for Israeli assassinations and terrorist acts against civilians.

Israel is the big loser, and its ability to serve as America's proxy has been crippled. The devastation from Iranian rockets has left a reported one-third of Tel Aviv and much of Haifa in ruins.

Israel has lost not only its key military and national security structures but will lose much of its skilled population as it emigrates, taking its industry with it.

By intervening on Israel's side by supporting its genocide, the United States has turned most of the UN's Global Majority against it.

Washington's ill-thought-out backing of the reckless Netanyahu has catalyzed the drive by other countries to speed their way out of the US diplomatic, economic, and military orbit.

So, America's Oil War against Iran can now be added to the long list of wars that the United States has lost since the Korean and Vietnam wars, Afghanistan, Iraq, and the rest of its adventures, leading up to its imminent loss in Ukraine. Its victories have been against Grenada and German industry—its own imperial "backyard," so to speak.

This essay appeared on [Michael's substack](#) on 29 June 2025.

Michael Hudson (michael-hudson.com) is President of The Institute for the Study of Long-Term Economic Trends (ISLET), a Wall Street Financial Analyst, and Distinguished Research Professor of Economics at the University of Missouri, Kansas City. He is the author of [Super-Imperialism: The Economic Strategy of American Empire](#), ...and forgive them their debts: [Lending, Foreclosure and Redemption—From Bronze Age Finance to the Jubilee Year](#), [J is for Junk Economics](#), [Killing the Host](#), [The Bubble and Beyond](#), amongst many others.

A Lamentation

SAMMY ATTOH

For the souls of Gaza, and all who mourn unheard.

I weep for the children whose names were never written in victory, only in ledgers of loss.

I cry for the mothers whose wombs bore only graves and whose lullabies are now silence.

The streets run with fear thick as blood, and the walls echo with prayers unanswered.

How many times must the sun rise on the bones of brothers buried in dust?

They say “security,” but I see only siege. They say “conflict,” but I hear colonization.

They say “both sides,” but I count bodies, and they are not balanced.

My lament is not for politics but for proximity—to pain, to powerlessness, to the peril of being born in the wrong place beneath the wrong sky.

And yet—beneath rubble, songs. In alleyways, resistance. In every mother’s whisper, the vocabulary of survival.

I write this not for attention—but because silence is betrayal. And I, I choose to speak.

Sammy Attoh is a Human Rights Coordinator, poet, and public writer. A member of The Riverside Church in New York City and The New York State Chaplains Group, he advocates for spiritual renewal and systemic justice. Originally from Ghana, his work draws on ancestral wisdom to explore the sacred connections between people, the planet, and posterity.

How We Change Our Minds

Reflections on Resistance and Representation

MAURA FINKELSTEIN

I’m obsessed with questions of memory. I’m a nonfiction writer and have spent most of my life trying to write stories from the position of partial memory, in conversation with folks who also are drawing on partial memory. As an anthropologist, I used to take obsessive field notes. As a person who is now writing more from a personal and less from an analytical perspective, I’ve found that sometimes the incompleteness of memory is just as much the story as what actually happened. Here’s a story about memory.

Last week (as you all probably know), the *NYTimes Magazine* published an article about academic freedom, featuring my story. As a writer, I hate being written about (and for folks who think I wrote the article—I didn’t! It was written by Sarah Viren, I was just the subject). Writing is about control, it’s about making a dictatorial choice around language, narrative, and structure (to name just a few devices). I don’t like relinquishing control over those things, I don’t like letting someone else tell my story. I also hate being photographed for similar reasons. Control, frame, angle. I don’t like being the subject of someone else’s story. In any case, that has made the past year very weird for me.

While I was going through the fact-checking process (which was pretty extensive), I was alerted to a quote from a former student, who was in class with me during the Fall 2023 semester. Remembering the infamous class meeting of October 12th, the student said of me, “She actively said: ‘I do not condone Hamas or its actions. I think that violence is horrible....’ But her caveat to that was, ‘but it’s not unexpected.’”

Now, maybe I said that (this is a good student, with a great memory, who I have known for a long time). But it didn’t sound like me (or it sounded like an extracted sentence from a longer something I said). When I went back-to-back to my notes, which I agonized over for days, this is what I actually wrote down to say to my class:

“Hamas is categorized as a terrorist organization in the west, but it is actually an activist organization, liberation group, and elected political party that also contains a wing involved in arms resistance. While I’m not condoning the events of October 7th, I do want to stress that we should not be at all surprised, given 75 years of Israeli occupation and genocide, in addition to the ongoing blockade of Gaza. If we are going to talk about Hamas, we have to actually understand what the group is and does.”

As context, in the aftermath of October 7, 2023, as the dust was settling and various forms of Zionist atrocity propaganda was being circulated (in large part by the *NYTimes*), I told my students I would dedicate October 12th to answering their questions and asked them to send me those questions beforehand if they wanted to ask something but felt scared or intimidated to do so in front of the class. All the questions (or at least almost all the questions) were about Hamas.

So, what I remember about that week was knowing that I had to go into my classroom and talk about Hamas, Al Aqsa Flood, and the genocidal aftermath of October

7th, perpetuated by the Zionist State. I knew that some of my students might be Zionists, whether actively or passively, and so I wanted to strategically speak to them in ways that didn't immediately lose them. I wanted them to understand the context, engage history, and take seriously the violence of a Jewish supremacist state. I also knew, despite my Zionist detractors online, that my job was not to give my personal political take but instead give my students the information they needed in order to have an informed understanding of ongoing genocidal events. Writing out what I said to my class that day resulted in an essay I wrote, called 'Reframing Hamas', published by Allegra Lab in December 2023.

I'm not saying I got it right that day (or in that essay). But I did try (while most of my colleagues, across campus and throughout the country, said nothing). And that day set off a series of events that eventually led to me being investigated and fired by my college.

In any case, I was upset that there was no room in the article for me to contribute a more nuanced quote of what I said that day in class, considering the time I spent choosing my words. But I didn't think much of it when the article came out, as the quote was a memory from a student, recalled more than a year after the event. We all remember the past differently and my own political investments have developed extensively over the past twenty months. Anything I would have said two years ago is likely different from what I would say today.

I was reminded of that passage later in the day, however, when someone who follows me on Twitter reposted a screenshot of the student's memory from the article, as evidence that I am actually a Zionist and don't support resistance. I don't write any of this from a defensive position (I hope). And it's none of my business what other people post about me online, unless they want to engage me, which—as long as you're not a Zionist—I welcome (note—I dm'd [send a private message on social media to] this person and never heard back. For the record, I do not think they owe me anything, including engagement, but I would have liked to talk with them). Instead, I'm thinking about how many of us have approached the past twenty months—as a necessary education, given to us by many Palestinians, who are telling us about their experience living and dying through genocide (as well as apartheid, ethnic cleansing, and the absolutely dehumanizing rhetoric of Israel, the US, and their Western allies). It is a gift to be able to change one's mind. My own thinking has developed exponentially over the past twenty months, mostly due to:

1. Being in conversation with my Palestinian friends
2. Reading writing by Palestinian thinkers and artists
3. Following Palestinians (both in occupied Palestine and the diaspora) on social media.

This has been a great education, and my thinking has developed in two major ways:

First, I have more publicly and clearly spoken out in support of resistance, by any means possible, including violent resistance. This is partially a moral and ethical stance—colonized and oppressed people have a moral and ethical right to resist their occupiers and people experiencing genocide and ethnic cleansing have a moral

and ethical right to resist those who are annihilating them. I support this resistance by any means necessary. I also have no interest in glorifying nonviolent resistance (and I think the division between violent and nonviolent is not as clear as some of us would like to imagine it is). If we look at the BDS movement, the Great March of Return, or the 2010 Freedom Flotilla, "nonviolent" resistance is treated the same as violent resistance (BDS has been criminalized, protestors at Gaza's Great March of Return actions were shot, maimed, and murdered by the thousands, and the 2010 Freedom Flotilla ended with Israel murdering 9 activists). As Israel's interception of the Madleen and abduction of 12 activists in International waters has revealed, non-violent resistance cannot and will not end state violence. In fact, it never has, and, as we have seen, from Palestine to Los Angeles, condemnation of violent resistance merely legitimizes and supports state violence.

This argument is also a legal one—the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) has explicitly acknowledged the right of Palestinians to resist Israel's military occupation, including through armed struggle. This right is clearly stated in UNGA Resolution 3314 (1974) and UNGA Resolution 37/43 (1982). After watching the worst things imaginable being done to Palestinian people in Gaza every day for the past 20 months, how can we work towards dismantling this genocidal imperial structure, both materially and intellectually? Almost a million people have been murdered, millions more are on the brink of starvation. Palestinians are being bombed, sniped, burned alive by Israel and its allies. Palestinians are being crushed under buildings, raped, beaten, attacked by dogs. Left to die in incubators. Frozen to death. Denied water & healthcare. Starved to death. All resistance against this horror is justified.

The lesson here is that our job is to resist empire and domination, whether this violence is occurring in Palestine, Sudan, Congo, or here in the United States.

Here's a second way I have changed my mind—I have shifted the way I want to show up in the world as a Jewish person. As a caveat, I have always had, at best, an ambivalent relationship with Judaism. I'm not religious and I have never found joy or a sense of belonging in predominantly Jewish spaces. This may be for many reasons but mainly it's because of Zionism. Most of the Jewish spaces I encountered as a young person were also explicitly Zionist and I wanted nothing to do with this ideology. However, for years, beginning in 2004 and stretching until last year, I would identify as an anti-Zionist Jewish person in order to counter the idea that Judaism and Zionism are inextricably linked. I would argue that Judaism and Zionism are not the same, I would argue that anti-Zionism is not antisemitism. The first thing I wrote and published after Al Aqsa Flood was an essay called "Never Again Means Never Again for Anyone." I thought being Jewish protected me from these accusations of antisemitism (it didn't) and I felt a moral obligation to resist a Jewish supremacist project of settler colonial genocide. When the opportunity arose, I would draw on "Jewish values" as a reason to decry genocide.

I have stopped doing this. In large part because I have learned, mostly from Palestinian friends and folks I read or follow on social media, that doing so actually reproduces the Jewish supremacy anti-Zionist Jews claim to resist. There is actually nothing inherently anti-genocide about Judaism and drawing on Jewish values (which I have been guilty of doing in the past) frames Jewish people as somehow morally

superior in this struggle. We are not. Jewish people have a moral obligation to engage the work of dismantling Zionism (as Zionism/Jewish supremacy is genocidal) but we are not more moral because we do this work. This distinction isn't complicated — this work is the bare minimum for being a person right now.

So, these are two major ways my thinking has changed over the past 20 months. As a teacher and lifelong learner, I know it is both scary and necessary to change our minds. I hope I keep learning and growing and developing my thinking around Palestine, liberation, resistance, and a more just future. This is part of the work.

Lastly, a commenter wrote that my comments on resistance was “disappointing” and wondered “did we ever ask what Maura's politics was?” So here is an inexhaustive list of some of my political commitments, in case you are curious:

Things I am working to dismantle:

Capitalism; Imperialism; Supremacist ideology, including Zionism, a Jewish supremacist project; The Nation State/borders; The police (ACAB ACAB ACAB) [an acronym that stands for “All Cops Are Bastards”]; TERFism [Gender-critical feminism, also known as trans-exclusionary radical feminism]

Things I support:

Liberation struggles; All forms of resistance against occupation, apartheid, genocide, and other settler colonial violence; The fall of white supremacist heteropatriarchy; The end of “Western Civilization”; Socialism (including universal health care, free education, and access to housing/food/water for all); Disability justice; Not eating animals; Mutual Aid.

On that last note, right now, 90% of the conversations I am having with folks are some versions of “what can we do?” One thing we can all do, regardless of financial situation, is support mutual aid projects to get food and aid into Gaza (and Sudan). This might be by donating, it might be by sharing campaigns. My friend Ammiel is currently supporting the campaign of a talented artist in Gaza named Kholoud Hammad and I want to highlight her here:

“Kholoud is one of many incredibly talented & truly great artists still working in Gaza, documenting the genocide & ongoing life in the midst of it. Follow this [link](#) to donate. In addition to the fundraising campaign, this page has an excellent interview with her from a few months ago (you can also read it [here](#)). You can also see some of her work, along with links on how to contribute to her & her family's needs & how to purchase prints through Gerard Dalbon, an extraordinary artist himself, who curated a recent exhibit & auction of work by Palestinian artists in Gaza at Mayday in Brooklyn. If you are on Instagram, you can see more of Kholoud's work & follow her [here](#).”

I know some folks are stretched very thin financially. I get it. But for all of us, the bare minimum we can do right now is pay attention, learn, and be willing to change our mind. I have changed my mind a lot. I will continue to change my mind. I'm grateful for this opportunity. I take responsibility for past harms I have caused. This is something we all owe to each other — accountability and growth. I'm grateful to have an outlet for this with you all, here.

In the next week or two, I will share a list of resources (books, articles, etc.) that have really helped me these past two years. For now, I'll say that I have been spending time with Ghassan Kanafani's *Selected Political Writings*, Mohammed El-Kurd's *Perfect Victims* (buy both these books [here](#) and the proceeds go to The Sameer Project), and publications that emerged from The Palestine Research Center (including Fayeze Sayegh's *Zionist Colonialism in Palestine* (1965). Stay tuned for more.

In the meantime, don't stop talking about Palestine.

Maura Finkelstein is a writer, ethnographer, anthropologist, anti-Zionist, and author of The Archive of Loss: Lively Ruination in Mill Land Mumbai (DUP 2019). Readers can follow her on Twitter and Instagram and subscribe to [her Substack](#), where she writes about The Sameer Project and raises money for Gaza mutual aid. Her website is <https://www.maurafinkelstein.com/>.

Throughout history there has been only one thing that ruling classes have ever wanted — and that is everything: all the choice lands, forests, game, herds, harvests, mineral deposits and precious metals of the earth; all the wealth, riches, and profitable- returns; all the productive facilities, gainful inventiveness, and technologies; all the surplus value produced by human labor; all the control positions of the state and other major institutions; all the public supports and subsidies; all the protections of the law with none of the constraints; all the services, comforts, luxuries and advantages of civil society with none of the taxes and costs. Every ruling class has wanted only this: all the rewards and none of the benefits.

Michael Parenti, “Global Rollback After Communism,” Covert Action Quarterly, Spring, 2022.

Colonization

HARRY FABER

We over here
Control so much over there,
At least we want to.
We are trying to.
We'll stage coups too.
We'll kill too,
We'll murder too,
We build bombs,
We make guns,
All for what?
Who's happy doing this?
Is all we can do just watch?
Empathy.
What if it were you?
What if it were you?
What if it were you?
What if it were your friends?
What if it were your family?
What if it were your kids?
What if it were you?
"They're all the same!"
We're all the same!
They are us and we are them.
Yet we kill them.
Not you but we.
It's normalized in our society.
We are the peasants born into the
kingdom,
Swaddled in lies, taught to obey.
We accept this is the way it is,
Just as the us of the past accepted it.
Not all but most.
Here in the heart of the empire,
Most just go on, and on, and on,
While the wheels of the machine
bomb the world to dust.

Day after day,
Day after day,
Day after day,
Kept in the cycle fueled by lies
So much lies,
So much lies,
Everywhere, anywhere,
Lie, after lie, after lie,
Lies told unaware of their reality,
Lies unknowingly regurgitated,
unintentional.
When all you're fed is lies,
When all you see is lies,
When all you hear is lies,
It's no wonder why others go mad.
What's easier to wonder is "Why
haven't I?"
Kept in the cycle fueled by hatred.
So much hatred
We hate me, we hate you.
But you are me, and me is you.
We hate ourselves, is that the truth?
I say no, it can't be.
But then again,
I feel so dumb and small and weak.
I feel the weight of my insignificance,
Daring it to not be true.
I will not be a cog in the machine,
Not me and no longer you.
I want to change it, so I'll lead with
love,
But love can't bring back the dead,
Perhaps it can help soak up all the
tears that were shed.
But what of the echo?
The reverberation of screams,

That lingers in the bones of the earth,
And the extinguishing of our dreams?
Do not worry, do not fret.
The screams can be replayed
endlessly
On all of our screens.
Change is not easy,
As obvious as it seems.
The beauty of hope is it dances, it
gleams.
Change is like capital,
It compounds over time.
The fight for what's right,
Has always been an uphill climb.
I know the weight of the world feels
too heavy to hold,
But maybe, just maybe,
When we are through,
The weight of the world will feel a
little lighter,
And the echoes of screams will fade
into truth.
The liberated children,
May finally be able to enjoy their
childhood,
Their youth.
What are they liberated from?
We must not forget,
The people were liberated,
From colonial wrath.
These children will sing,
They will dance, they will laugh.
The future is truth,
Subjugation the past.
For their sake, and ours,
May the future come fast.
The future is unyielding,
Along with it, time.
Meanwhile the addiction to
distraction,
Keeps robbing us blind.

Change starts with us,
It starts with love,
It starts with trust.
But change will not happen,
Until we refuse to get up from our
seats on the front of the bus.
Once we refuse,
We stop being complicit,
The age of imperialism,
We can be the ones who finally
dismiss it.
We must carry the torch,
From those who came before,
For those who will come after,
I cannot reiterate it enough,
Change does not just start with me,
Change starts with us.
And when change finally is upon us,
Change will bring a world that is
conscious,
That is honest.
In this new world,
Free from hyper imperialism,
Perhaps they will see things through
a new lens,
Through a new prism.
People can pause
And people can wonder,
How the world ever got to be this
way,
The joy and the blessing it is to see
each new day.
And why it took us
So long to see.

*Harry Faber is a Moravian University
alumnus.*

What Anti-Imperialists Can Learn from the Case of Syria: An Interview with Max Ajl

BLACK ALLIANCE FOR PEACE

In March 2025, Syria witnessed horrific sectarian massacres by government-backed forces targeting Alawites in the country's northwest coastal regions. Since the violent takeover of the Syrian government by Hay'at Tahrir al-Sham (HTS) in November/December 2024, nearly 8,000 people, mostly civilians, have been killed.

HTS, far from being an independent actor, functions as a proxy force advancing the geopolitical interests of the United States, Israel, and their allies, whose primary goal is to destabilize the region and maintain control over its resources. Damascus governor Maher Marwan indicates that HTS wants peace with Israel, while Israel's destruction of Syria's armed forces and anti-air defenses after HTS's takeover of Damascus has elicited seemingly no criticism, let alone an armed response from Syria's new rulers.

On May 21, BAP's Asia-Pacific Team conducted this interview with Max Ajl to discuss what anti-imperialist organizers can learn from the case of Syria. Ajl is a scholar at MECAM/University of Tunis and the Tunisian Observatory for Food Sovereignty and the Environment (OSAE). The following interview has been edited for length and clarity.

Asia-Pacific News Update: How is the propaganda around regime change in Syria still effective? How can we inoculate radical movements in the West from the kind of propaganda that enabled the Syrian regime change operation?

Max Ajl: The fundamental issue is that most people, even people who are critics of what is currently occurring in Syria, maintain an unanalyzed or under-analyzed sense of what it means when people claim that Syria had an organic uprising or a suppressed, mass-based, or liberatory revolution—this, before we even get to the “opposition” and its violence, which was present from the beginning.

There's a myth about what happened in Syria from 2011–14, or even later. Although I disagree with a lot of Bassam Haddad's approach, he wrote an article about this for *The Nation*, about the conflicting narratives about the Syrian uprising, and these narratives that become ironclad mechanisms through which people need to see the world. So, of course, there were people who “rose up” in Syria—and maybe they used words like “freedom”, and maybe they also used words like “justice.” What is that telling us? Yes, people thought they were fighting for justice, but we need to know a lot more. And this process of critical scrutiny includes: Who were these people who were rising up? How much of the population did they represent?

Where did they come from? Also, what were their actual aspirations? What was justice filled with? Who were they linked to? What external forces were they warm to and what were they cold to? And what was the role of violence? These are blocked from the entire discourse, so the model of a Syrian regime change can remain easily

re-implementable in other sovereign states, because the way that the operation worked remains opaque.

But there have been several fundamental things that have been publicly documented. From 2005 onwards, USAID and the NED were very active in Syria, promoting notions of liberalism and democracy against the reigning Syrian government—which had extreme democratic deficits. And they were selling this to young people, and then many of these young people participated in the 2011 protests and said, “Yes, we are fighting for freedom and democracy”, which of course, is very appealing to a western audience who believe that these are meaningful categories—these are fundamental governing myths of our own system.

Many of these people were then equipped with all sorts of radios and other communication equipment to film certain types of repressive acts, which did occur without any question, to create a media discourse which was then beamed worldwide by the western media but also by the Qatari media, that said there is a popular revolution for freedom and democracy that is being violently repressed. But the historical reality had so many other facets that were removed and ground down, so we could only see one facet.

Such as: who else was mobilizing alongside these liberal young people?

One, there was a lot of sectarianism; it was well known, there was an extreme level of sectarianism, anti-Alawi, anti-Christian. This was suppressed. And the liberals more or less thought that they could ride the wave of an agitation with a certain degree of sectarianism and use it to implement a form of liberal democracy. Others in the local coordination committees thought that the US would do what it had done to Libya and just use immense air violence against the military in Syria and take out the state. There were people who definitely thought that.

Overwhelmingly amongst the liberals and the sectarians, there was not a principled opposition to foreign intervention in Syria. That was a very minority position amongst the people who partook in these protests. What's also missing is that every society has discontent. Discontent is a normalized aspect of social and political life. Any social formation is going to produce political discontent. Yet, discontent is widely understood in the Arab-Iranian region as something that means: “get rid of the existing regime”, which then creates a zero-sum competition for power. And if one of those sides is backed by the US, that's the very definition of imperialism—you can find Biden saying that the Saudis and the Qataris were pouring in money, and you can find the former Qatari foreign minister saying “Yes, we poured in billions of dollars to accomplish regime change in Syria.” He openly admits it, and others have openly admitted that US Special Forces were on the ground, “filtering” weapons from Turkey to make sure they went to the appropriate destinations.

Furthermore, the violence itself started already in March 2011, with attacks on civilian buses, police stations, snipers shooting into crowds, and even massacres of security forces. All of this is erased through the nice notion of a “peaceful revolution,” which only reluctantly and defensively militarized. In fact, this narrative is simply incorrect.

Asia-Pacific News Update: It seems that you have to be agnostic on the question of imperialism to be able to believe the narrative that this was a liberation struggle.

Is there a prerequisite of understanding imperialism and how it works before you can really understand what's going on in Syria?

Max Ajl: Or you understand, to be very crude about it, that if the US is involved in another country, it is for the worse. In fact, the uprising's partisans call this a very crude framework. And I say "yes, let us start with a crude tool." Sometimes, a crude tool is very effective. A hammer, in fact, is a crude tool, but it's very effective for driving a nail in. And for building opposition to the US, for people North and South. For building a common front against the violence that the US inflicts in the world, a crude and very appropriate tool is a hardline, unrelenting, black and white opposition to the project of US power.

Asia-Pacific News Update: Can we learn something about US imperialism through the example of what's happened in Syria over the past 10 years, or even since November/December 2024? Is this a case study that can help inform our understanding about what the US is doing around the world, whether in Africa or domestically?

Max Ajl: Paris Yeros wrote about this in the context of Mozambique, that in the current moment of widespread post-Soviet ideological confusion, widespread lack of organizing cadres that have helped people orient politically to the world, and the widespread destructuring of peripheral social formations such that you have systemic semi-proletarianization, you have a lot of people who are confused about the world they live in, which is legitimate.

There are accordingly widespread bases for the US to implement these so-called democracy-promotion projects that are based on alleging, inciting, or even the actuality of unrest within states that are still emerging from the anticolonial struggles, and then observing that those states often respond to unrest with violence and the US can try to weaponize that unrest to burn down and destabilize the country, impose sanctions and so forth. We've seen this happen in Libya; the US is constantly trying to do this in Iran; the US did it in Syria; the US tried to do it to some extent in Lebanon, which remains under severe financial siege and Hezbollah remains severely embattled. It happened in Mozambique, in Zimbabwe through the urban trade unions and their associated western-funded civil society, strongly supported by western academics and so forth.

People don't understand that war is actually the method of accumulation by the US. The US encourages war. So much of the profit of the US involves the subjugation of Third World social formations and the instilling of a sense of defeat, and this is how the US is able—with a not-very-large portion of world global productive capacity—to maintain such a large share of global wealth, precisely because it intimidates and clobbers the rest of the world, and war is part of that.

The technologies of militarization that are developed through co-production between the US and Israel, for example, are then deployed in the United States. The counterinsurgency that's been tested against the Palestinian people is then used against people here. There's a lot of work—for example, *Tip of the Spear*, the recent book about how there's this kind of war that the US state apparatus is engaged in; counterinsurgency against racialized populations in terms of preventing the coalescing of political projects. So, I don't think it's a coincidence, for example, that the

most policed and repressed of the popular movements have always been those forces identifying as national or national liberation struggles—in Black, Puerto Rican, and Indigenous communities.

Asia-Pacific News Update: What is the task for anti-imperialists in the west? It sounds like the task is really to continue educating people about the devastating impacts of sanctions.

Max Ajl: We need to educate people about sanctions, about the terror lists; we need to clarify the mechanisms of contemporary hybrid, asymmetrical warfare; how it's operating through the media; what are the types of narratives the US uses; what weaknesses it's exploiting in peripheral states. We need to know all of that. We need to educate ourselves. We need this knowledge to know where to go. And this was basic from Cabral, also. Cabral's like a lodestar. He said, "No, there's never been a successful revolution without a revolutionary theory." A theory is knowledge, it's abstraction, it's identifying the relationship between concepts and a map of historical reality. So, we need to educate ourselves to move politically in an effective way.

Asia-Pacific News Update: Is there some sobering lesson here for countries like Iran, Russia, or China?

Max Ajl: First, there's much more bilateral trade occurring on a world scale, settled in non-US currencies, and it's only going to escalate. Two, every time China is sanctioned, it moves to do what is called an import substitution process: it actually has to produce that industrial process domestically, and that's what it's doing with microchips right now. So, I think it's always been understood by the Russians, Chinese and Iranians, but now it's acutely understood that you need to have national sovereignty over technology; that you need a sovereign industrialization; this is so clear to everyone.

Asia-Pacific News Update: For Syria, do you envision a Libya scenario with years of continuous civil war and state collapse?

Max Ajl: I don't want to say something false; the situation in Syria is disastrous. I hope they get out of it, but the Syrian people are exhausted by sanctions and war. I don't think they apportion blame correctly, but they're exhausted and it's going to be a very long struggle.

This interview originally appeared on The Black Alliance For Peace, Asia-Pacific News Update #1 July 15, 2025

<https://blackallianceforpeace.com/afghanistannewsupdate/asia-pacific-news-update-1>

Max Ajl is an associated researcher with the Tunisian Observatory for Food Sovereignty and the Environment and a postdoctoral fellow with the Rural Sociology Group at Wageningen University. He has written for Monthly Review, Jacobin, and Viewpoint. He has contributed to several journals, including the Journal of Peasant Studies, Review of African Political Economy and Globalizations. He serves as an associate editor at Agrarian South & Journal of Labor and Society.

Dismantling War Culture: How Militarization Shapes Our Everyday Lives



depositphotos

DAVID ANDERSSON

We are living in a particular moment where mainstream communicators want you to believe the world is in a state of permanent war—even when you are walking peacefully down your own street. Your phone relentlessly feeds you images of bombings. News channels and politicians constantly warn you of imminent danger.

This is how a military culture is built. And for over two decades, the military-industrial complex has done a remarkable job of embedding itself in our minds. We are led to believe the military exists to “defend” us and maintain “peace”—with Defense Ministries and UN Peacekeeping Forces masking their real operations. In the United States, every state is now integrated into this military machine, with arms factories that politicians proudly promote for being “good job creators.” Hollywood glorifies the military, routinely presenting soldiers as national heroes.

NATO recently “successfully” concluded its summit by securing a 5% GDP military spending commitment from each of its members. Italy just passed a new law expanding police and military powers to suppress so-called “bad” protesters. In the U.S., Trump deployed the National Guard against demonstrations in Los Angeles and opened a new detention facility, nicknamed “Alligator Alcatraz,” specifically designed for migrants awaiting deportation.

The military culture is deeply rooted in politics. Many politicians openly support, engage with, or are themselves part of the military establishment. Religious institutions also lend their support to military formations, with clergy and followers actively serving. Education has been militarized, too—military recruiters visit schools, officers give lectures at universities, and scholars devote entire careers to detailing the minutiae of wars. In the US, the Department of Defense (DOD) and higher education institutions have a long-standing, symbiotic relationship, with the DOD funding sig-

nificant academic research in areas like artificial intelligence, autonomous weapons, and advanced computing to address national security challenges.

The tech industry is fully engaged in military development, building AI-powered drones and surveillance systems. Scientific institutions developed the atomic bomb under the banner of “deterrence.” Cities deploy military-style police forces against their own populations. Even drug cartels have adopted military strategies for expansion, and some political movements maintain armed branches.

If you’re wondering how we ended up in the current catastrophe in Israel and Palestine, the answer is simple: Israel is a militarized society. Military service is compulsory—32 months for men and 24 months for women, followed by years of reserve duty. The military is not just a structure; it is the culture that shapes the entire state.

We celebrate these people as heroes who make the “ultimate sacrifice”—yet we rarely dedicate a day to honor teachers, nurses, doctors, or farmers.

There is a profound irony in the fact that governments today allocate virtually unlimited budgets to military spending, yet offer no comparable funding for the development of nonviolence. There are no grand investments, no national programs, no ministries dedicated to building peace, fostering reconciliation, or cultivating nonviolence in daily life. Contrast this with the European Renaissance—a cultural revolution generously funded by kings and rulers who, despite their own contradictions, invested heavily in the arts, science, and philosophy. They recognized, at least in part, the power of culture to shape civilization. Today, we pour trillions into perfecting weapons but invest almost nothing in creating the conditions for a nonviolent future. This absence is not accidental—it reflects the priorities of a system addicted to conflict.

Wars are not accidents. They are manufactured. They cannot be stopped simply by calling for peace. We must dismantle the war culture embedded in our towns, cities, families, and neighborhoods. Remove politicians who propose military solutions. Demand the closure of military bases. Transform military academies into schools of nonviolence and peace. Redirect tax money from military budgets to vital social services like housing, infrastructure, health, and education.

Wars are the metastasis of a global addiction to violence—a cultural cancer that we must confront and heal.

This article was first published on Pressenza and translated into Spanish.

David Andersson is a writer and humanist based in New York City. He focuses on issues of global justice, collective consciousness, and nonviolent transformation. He co-directs Pressenza International Press Agency and is the author of The White-West: A Look in the Mirror, a collection of op-eds examining the dynamics of Western identity and its global impact. CounterPunch, denikreferendum.cz, Mobilized News, Countercurrents, LA Progressive, and Dissident Voice have published his recent work. Many of his articles have been translated into more than five languages.

Stop Israel's Dystopian "Humanitarian City" Plan — Before It's Too Late

MEDEA BENJAMIN



The ruins of the city of Rafah. Photo: Getty Images

The Israeli government has just put forward one of the most brazenly genocidal schemes in modern memory—and unless we act immediately, the world will once again let it happen.

As reported in *Haaretz*, Israeli Defense Minister Israel Katz is proposing to force some 600,000 Palestinians—and eventually the entire population of Gaza—into a fenced-in “humanitarian city” to be built on the ruins of Rafah in southern Gaza. The plan is to “screen” the population, separate out alleged Hamas members, and then pressure the remaining civilians—men, women, and children—to “voluntarily” leave Gaza for another country. Which country? That hasn’t even been determined. The point isn’t relocation—it’s erasure. This reflects a long-standing goal among many Israelis, especially on the right, to take full control of Gaza and clear it of Palestinians.

The UN has warned that the deportation or forcible transfer of an occupied territory’s civilian population is strictly prohibited under international humanitarian law and “tantamount to ethnic cleansing”.

While all eyes are focused on a possible ceasefire, Gallant is not interested in peace—he’s interested in a “final solution.” A speeding up of the second Nakba we have been witnessing for the past 20 months. In fact, he has stated that construction would begin during a 60-day ceasefire. So what’s the point of a ceasefire, if it’s used to build a concentration camp?

Once Palestinians are herded into this camp, they will not be allowed to leave for other parts of Gaza. They won’t be allowed to return to what’s left of their homes,

their neighborhoods, their farms, their schools. They will be trapped inside this militarized zone, under constant surveillance, held at gunpoint until Israel can arrange their deportation.

Just think of the tragic, unbearable irony: the Israeli government—founded in the aftermath of the Holocaust—is now building a massive concentration camp for an entire population.

If that sounds unthinkable, look at what Israel has already gotten away with.

For the past 20 months, the world has watched—and largely enabled—a genocidal campaign in Gaza. Over 55,000 Palestinians have been slaughtered, the majority of them women and children. Israel has bombed hospitals, schools, refugee camps, and mosques. It has flattened entire neighborhoods with AI-generated kill lists. It has assassinated journalists, targeted ambulances, destroyed bakeries and water systems.

It has used hunger as a weapon of war, deliberately blocking aid trucks, attacking convoys, and starving the population into desperation. And in a cruel twist, it has created the U.S.-backed Gaza Humanitarian Foundation—a scheme to funnel aid through Israeli-controlled routes and sideline the UN and experienced NGOs. Its so-called “distribution points” are really death traps, where desperate people have been shot day after day as they risk their lives to get a bit of food.

This engineered starvation is not an accident. It is a strategy—a form of collective punishment on a scale rarely seen in modern times.

We have already failed the people of Gaza—again and again. We failed when we looked the other way as children were buried in rubble. We failed when we allowed our tax dollars to fund the very bombs that wiped out refugee camps. We failed when we kept pretending there was still a line Israel wouldn’t cross.

Now Katz is telling us—explicitly—what comes next: mass internment and forced expulsion. And unless we rise up with every ounce of outrage we have, we will fail again.

Let’s be absolutely clear: the infrastructure for this plan is already being built. Netanyahu and Trump are lobbying corrupt governments in the Global South to accept the deported. This is not a negotiating tactic to strengthen Israel’s position in ceasefire talks—it is the next phase of a genocide we’ve been watching in real time for nearly two years.

And what is the U.S. government doing? Still issuing meaningless statements about “Israel’s right to defend itself.” Still shipping weapons. Still blocking accountability at the United Nations—and even sanctioning officials like UN Special Rapporteur Francesca Albanese for daring to speak out.

President Trump could stop this today—by cutting off military aid, backing the International Criminal Court’s investigations, and declaring that forced displacement of Palestinians will not be tolerated. But instead, he’s still dreaming of turning Gaza into a Middle Eastern resort for the ultra-rich.

Meanwhile, more Arab governments stand ready to normalize ties with Israel, making deals with war criminals while their fellow Arabs are starved, bombed, and now threatened with mass exile. Where is the outcry from Cairo, Riyadh, Amman? Is there absolutely no red line?

One bright spot on the international scene is the Hague group, which will convene an emergency meeting in Colombia on July 15–16. This growing bloc of nations has joined South Africa's genocide case against Israel at the International Court of Justice. These countries are taking a courageous stand to uphold international law and defend Palestinian life. Every nation that claims to value justice must join them — immediately.

And here in the United States, every member of Congress must be pushed — loudly, relentlessly — to take a public stand. No more vague language. No more hiding behind mealy-mouthed scripts. We demand immediate, public opposition to this “humanitarian city” plan — and a full cutoff of military support to Israel. This is a moment of moral reckoning. Choose a side.

Don't fool yourself into thinking this can't happen. It is happening. The groundwork is being laid. The walls are going up. The deportation flights are being negotiated.

There is no neutral ground. This is not a policy debate. This is genocide — on camera, with diplomatic cover, and with our tax dollars.

The time to stop Israel's dystopian plan is not tomorrow. It is now.

Rise up. Speak out. Flood the streets. Bombard Congress. Demand accountability.

Stop the plan. Save Gaza. Before it's too late.

Medea Benjamin is the co-founder of the women-led peace group CODEPINK and co-founder of the human rights group Global Exchange. She is the author of 11 books, including War in Ukraine: Making Sense of a Senseless Conflict, coauthored with Nicolas J.S. Davies. Her most recent book, coauthored with David Swanson, is NATO: What You Need to Know.

“I do not admit that the dog [the Palestinians] in the manger has the final right to the manger, even though he may have lain there for a very long time.”

— Winston Churchill,

Trump, Epstein, and the Deep State

CHRIS HEDGES

“The Trump administration's refusal to release the Epstein files and videos is done not only to protect Trump, but the ruling class. They all belong to the same club.”



American Satyricon —Mr. Fish

The refusal by the Trump administration to release the files and videos amassed during investigations into the activities of the pedophile Jeffrey Epstein should put to rest the absurd idea, embraced by Trump supporters and gullible liberals, that Trump will dismantle the Deep State. Trump is [part of](#), and has long been part of, the repugnant cabal of politicians — Democrat and Republican — billionaires and celebrities who look at us, and often underage girls and boys, as commodities to exploit for profit or pleasure.

The list of those who were in Epstein's orbit is a who's who of the rich and famous. They include not only [Trump](#), but [Bill Clinton](#), who allegedly took a trip to Thailand with Epstein, [Prince Andrew](#), [Bill Gates](#), hedge fund billionaire [Glenn Dubin](#), former New Mexico governor [Bill Richardson](#), former Secretary of the Treasury and former president of Harvard University [Larry Summers](#), cognitive psychologist and author [Stephen Pinker](#), [Alan Dershowitz](#), billionaire and Victoria's Secret CEO [Leslie Wexner](#), the former Barclays banker [Jes Staley](#), former Israeli prime minister [Ehud Barak](#), the magician [David Copperfield](#), actor [Kevin Spacey](#), former CIA director [Bill Burns](#), real estate mogul [Mort Zuckerman](#), former Maine senator [George Mitchell](#) and disgraced Hollywood producer [Harvey Weinstein](#), who reveled in Epstein's perpetual [Bacchanalia](#).

They also include law firms and high-priced attorneys, federal and state prosecutors, private investigators, personal assistants, publicists, servants, and drivers. They include the numerous procurers and pimps, including Epstein's girlfriend and the daughter of [Robert Maxwell](#), Ghislaine Maxwell. They include the media and politicians who ruthlessly discredited and silenced the victims, and strong-armed anyone, including a handful of intrepid reporters, seeking to expose Epstein's crimes and circle of accomplices.

There is a lot that remains hidden. But there are some things we know. Epstein installed hidden cameras in his opulent residences and on his private Caribbean island, Little St. James, to capture his high-powered friends engaging in sexual romps and abuse of teenage and underage girls and boys. The recordings were blackmail gold. Were they part of an intelligence operation on behalf of the Israeli [Mossad](#)? Or were they used to ensure that Epstein had a steady source of investors who funneled him millions of dollars to avoid being outed? Or were they used for both? He shuttled underage girls between New York and Palm Beach on his private jet, the [Lolita Express](#), which was allegedly outfitted with a bed for group sex. His coterie of famous friends, including [Clinton](#) and [Trump](#), are recorded as traveling on the jet numerous times on released flight logs, although many other flight logs have disappeared.

Epstein's videos are in the vaults of the FBI, along with detailed evidence that would rip back the veil on the sexual proclivities and callousness of the powerful. I doubt there is a client list, as Attorney General Pam Bondi claims. There is also no single Epstein file. The investigative material amassed on Epstein fills many, many boxes, which would bury Bondi's desk and probably, if collected in one room, dominate most of the space in her office.

Did Epstein commit suicide, as the official autopsy report claims, by hanging himself in his jail cell on August 10, 2019, at the Metropolitan Correctional Center in New York City? Or was he murdered? Since the cameras recording activity in his cell the night were not functional, we do not know. Michael Baden, a forensic pathologist hired by Epstein's brother, who served as the chief medical examiner for New York City and was present at the autopsy, said he believes Epstein's autopsy suggests [homicide](#).

The Epstein case is important because it implodes the fiction of deep divisions between Democrats, who had no more interest in releasing the Epstein files than Trump, and the Republicans. They belong to the same club. It exposes how the courts and law enforcement agencies collude to shield powerful figures who engage in crimes. It lays bare the depravity of our exhibitionist ruling class, accountable to no one, free to violate, plunder, loot, and prey on the weak and the vulnerable. It is the tawdry record of our oligarchic masters, those who lack the capacity for shame or guilt, whether dressed up as Donald Trump or Joe Biden.

This class of ruling parasites was parodied in the first-century satirical novel "[Satyricon](#)" by [Gaius Petronius Arbiter](#), written during the reigns of Caligula, Claudius, and Nero. As in *Satyricon*, Epstein's circle was dominated by pseudo-intellectuals, pretentious buffoons, grifters, con artists, petty criminals, the insatiable rich, and the sexually depraved. Epstein and his inner circle routinely engaged in sexual perversions of Petronian proportions, as *The Miami Herald* investigative reporter Julie Brown, whose dogged reporting was largely responsible for reopening the federal investigation into Epstein and Maxwell, documents in her book *Perversion of Justice: The Jeffrey Epstein Story*.

As Brown writes, in 2016, an anonymous woman, using the pseudonym "Kate Johnson", filed a civil complaint in a federal court in California alleging she was raped by Trump and Epstein when she was thirteen, over a four-month period, from June to September 1994.

"I loudly pleaded with Trump to stop," she said in the lawsuit about being raped. "Trump responded to my pleas by violently striking me in the face with his open hand and screaming that he could do whatever he wanted."

Brown continues: Johnson said that Epstein invited her to a series of 'underage sex parties' at his New York mansion, where she met Trump. Enticed by promises of money and modeling opportunities, Johnson said she was forced to have sex with Trump several times, including once with another girl, twelve years old, whom she labeled 'Marie Doe'.

Trump demanded oral sex, the lawsuit said, and afterward he "pushed both minors away while angrily berating them for the 'poor' quality of the sexual performance," according to the lawsuit, filed April 26 in U.S. District Court in Central California.

Afterward, when Epstein learned that Trump had taken Johnson's virginity, Epstein allegedly 'attempted to strike her about the head with his closed fists,' angry he had not been the one to take her virginity. Johnson claimed that both men threatened to harm her and her family if she ever revealed what had happened.

The lawsuit states that Trump did not take part in Epstein's orgies but liked to watch, often while the thirteen-year-old "Kate Johnson" gave him a hand job.

It appears Trump was able to quash the lawsuit by buying her silence. She has since disappeared.

In 2008, Alex Acosta, then the U.S. Attorney for the Southern District of Florida, negotiated a [plea deal](#) for Epstein. The deal granted immunity from all federal criminal charges to Epstein, four named co-conspirators, and any unnamed "potential co-conspirators." The agreement shut down the FBI probe into whether there were more victims and other powerful figures who took part in Epstein's sex crimes. It halted the investigation and sealed the indictment. Trump, in what many consider an act of gratitude, appointed Acosta as Secretary of Labor in his first term.

Trump contemplated pardoning Ghislaine Maxwell after she was arrested in July 2020, fearing she would reveal details of his decades-long friendship with Epstein, according to Trump biographer Michael Wolff. In July 2022, Maxwell was sentenced to 20 years in prison.

“Jeffrey Epstein’s closest relationship in life was with Donald Trump...these were two guys joined at the hip for a good 15 years. They did everything together,” Wolff [told](#) host Joanna Coles on The Daily Beast Podcast. “And this is from sharing, pursuing women, hunting women, sharing at least one girlfriend for at least a year in this kind of rich-guy relationship with each other’s planes, to Epstein advising Trump on how to cheat on his taxes.”

The legal anomalies, including the disappearance of massive amounts of evidence incriminating Epstein, saw Epstein avoid federal sex-trafficking charges in 2007, when his attorneys negotiated the secret plea deal with Acosta. He was able to plead guilty to lesser state charges of soliciting a minor for prostitution.

The prominent men accused of engaging in Epstein’s carnival of pedophilia, including Epstein’s attorney Dershowitz, viciously [threaten](#) anyone who seeks to [expose](#) them. Dershowitz, for example, claims that an investigation, which he has refused to make public, by the former FBI director Louis Freeh proves he had never had sex with Epstein’s victim, Virginia Giuffre, who was [trafficked](#) at 17 to Prince Andrew. Giuffre, one of the few victims to publicly take on her abusers, said she was “passed around like a platter of fruit” among Epstein and Maxwell’s friends, until at the age of 19, when she escaped. She “[committed suicide](#)” in April 2025. Dershowitz has sent repeated threats to Brown and her editors at *The Miami Herald*.

Brown continues:

[Dershowitz] kept referring to information that was contained in sealed documents. He accused the newspaper of not reporting “facts” that he said were in those sealed documents. The truth is, I tried to explain, newspapers just can’t write about things because Alan Dershowitz says they exist. We need to see them. We need to verify them. Then, because I said “show me the material,” he publicly accused me of committing a criminal act by asking him to produce documents that were under court seal.

This is the way Dershowitz operates.

What disturbs me the most about Dershowitz is the way that the media, with few exceptions, fails to challenge him critically. Journalists fact-checked Donald Trump and others in his administration almost every day, yet, for the most part, the media seems to give Dershowitz a pass on the Epstein story.

In 2015, when Giuffre’s allegations first became public, Dershowitz went on every television program imaginable, swearing, among other things, that Epstein’s plane logs would exonerate him. “How do you know that?” he was asked.

He replied that he was never on Epstein’s plane during the time that Virginia was involved with Epstein.

But if the media had checked, they could have learned that he was indeed a passenger on the plane during that time period, according to the logs.

Then he testified, in a sworn deposition, that he never went on any plane trips without his wife. But he was listed on those passage manifests as traveling multiple times without his wife. During at least one trip, he was on the plane with a model named Tatiana.

Epstein donated money to Harvard and was made a visiting fellow in Harvard’s Department of Psychology, although he had no academic qualifications in the field. He was given a key card and pass code, as well as an office in the building that housed Harvard’s Program for Evolutionary Dynamics. He referred to himself in his press releases as “Science Philanthropist Jeffrey Epstein”, “Education activist Jeffrey Epstein”, “Evolutionary Jeffrey Epstein”, “Science patron Jeffrey Epstein”, and “Maverick hedge funder Jeffrey Epstein”.

Epstein, replicating the pretensions and vacuity of the characters who were parodied in the “Dinner with Trimalchio” chapter of *Satyricon*, organized elaborate dinner gatherings for his billionaire friends, including Elon Musk, Salar Kamangar, and Jeff Bezos. He dreamed up bizarre schemes of social engineering, including a [plan](#) to seed the human species with his own DNA by creating a baby compound at his sprawling ranch in New Mexico.

“Epstein was also obsessed with cryonics, the transhumanist philosophy whose followers believe that people can be replicated or brought back to life after they are frozen,” Brown writes. “Epstein apparently told some of the members of his scientific circle that he wanted to inseminate women with his sperm for them to give birth to his babies, and that he wanted his head and his [penis frozen](#).”

The Epstein story is a window into the moral bankruptcy, hedonism, and greed of the ruling class. This crosses political lines. It is the common denominator among Democratic politicians, such as Bill Clinton, philanthropists like Bill Gates, the billionaire class, and Trump. They are one class of predators and grifters. It is not only girls and women they exploit, but all of us.

Christopher Lynn Hedges is an American journalist, commentator, Presbyterian minister, and author of several books including Death of the Liberal Class (2010) and most recently The Greatest Evil is War (2022).

The Militarization and Weaponization of Media Literacy — *NATO Invades the Classroom*

NOLAN HIGDON AND SYDNEY SULLIVAN

During President Donald Trump's second term, education has remained a central battleground in American politics. Republicans claim that classrooms have become hotbeds of “woke” indoctrination, accusing educators of promoting progressive agendas and tolerating antisemitism. In contrast, Democrats argue that conservatives are systematically defunding and dismantling public and higher education precisely because it teaches values like diversity, equity, and inclusion. While these partisan skirmishes dominate headlines, they obscure a much deeper and more enduring issue that encompasses all of these issues and more: the influence of corporate and military power on public education.

For decades, scholars have warned that corporations have steadily infiltrated the classroom—not to promote critical thinking or democratic values, but to cultivate ideologies that reinforce capitalism, nationalism, and militarism. Critical media literacy educators, in particular, have drawn attention to the convergence of tech firms and military entities in education, offering so-called “free” digital tools that often serve as Trojan horses for data collection and ideological control.

One striking example is the rise of programs like NewsGuard, which uses public fears over fake news to justify increased surveillance of students' online activity. Relatedly, in 2018, the Atlantic Council partnered with Meta to perform “fact-checking” on platforms such as Facebook. In 2022, the US Marine Corps discussed developing media literacy training. It remains to be seen what training, if any, they will develop. However, what is known is that a large global player has entered the media literacy arena: the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO). While NATO presents its initiatives as supportive of media literacy and democratic education, these efforts appear to be oriented more toward reinforcing alignment with its strategic and political priorities than to fostering critical civic engagement.

NATO was created in 1949, during the Cold War, as a military alliance to contain communism. Although the war officially ended in 1991, NATO has expanded both its mission and membership. Today, it encompasses more than thirty member nations and continues to frame itself as a global force for peace, democracy, and security. But this self-image masks real conflicts of interest.

NATO is deeply intertwined with powerful nation-states and corporate actors. It routinely partners with defense contractors, tech firms, think tanks, and Western governments—all of which have a vested interest in maintaining specific political and economic systems. These relationships raise concerns when NATO extends its reach into education. Can a military alliance—closely linked to the defense industry and state propaganda—credibly serve as a neutral force in media education?

In 2022, NATO associates collaborated with the US-based Center for Media Literacy (CML) to launch a media literacy initiative framed as a strategic defense

against misinformation. The initiative included a report titled *Building Resiliency: Media Literacy as a Strategic Defense Strategy for the Transatlantic*, authored by CML's Tessa Jolls. It was accompanied by a series of webinars featuring military personnel, policy experts, and academics.

On the surface, the initiative appeared to promote digital literacy and civic engagement. But a closer look reveals a clear ideological agenda. Funded and organized by NATO, the initiative positioned media literacy not as a means of empowering students to think critically about how power shapes media, but as a defense strategy to protect NATO member states from so-called “hostile actors.” The curriculum emphasized surveillance, resilience, and behavior modification over reflection, analysis, and democratic dialogue.

Throughout their webinars, NATO representatives described the media environment as a battlefield, frequently using other war metaphors such as “hostile information activities” and “cognitive warfare.” Panelists argued that citizens in NATO countries were targets of foreign disinformation campaigns—and that media literacy could serve as a tool to inoculate them against ideological threats.

A critical review of NATO's media literacy initiative reveals several troubling themes. First, it frames media literacy as a protectionist project rather than an educational one. Students are portrayed less as thinkers to be empowered and more as civilians to be monitored, molded, and managed. In this model, education becomes a form of top-down, preemptive defense, relying on expert guidance and military oversight rather than democratic participation.

Second, the initiative advances a distinctly neoliberal worldview. It emphasizes individual responsibility over structural analysis. In other words, misinformation is treated as a user error, rather than the result of flawed systems, corporate algorithms, or media consolidation. This framing conveniently absolves powerful actors, including NATO and Big Tech, of their role in producing or amplifying disinformation.

Third, the initiative promotes a contradictory definition of empowerment. While the report and webinars often use the language of “citizen empowerment”, they ultimately advocate for surveillance, censorship, and ideological conformity. Panelists call for NATO to “dominate” the information space, and some even propose systems to monitor students' attitudes and online behaviors. Rather than encouraging students to question power—including NATO itself—this approach rewards obedience and penalizes dissent.

Finally, the initiative erases the influence of corporate power. Although it criticizes authoritarian regimes and “hostile actors”, it fails to examine the role that Western corporations, particularly tech companies, play in shaping media environments. This oversight is especially problematic given that many of these corporations are NATO's partners. By ignoring the political economy of media, the initiative offers an incomplete and ideologically skewed version of media literacy.

NATO's foray into media literacy education represents a new frontier in militarized pedagogy. While claiming to promote democracy and resilience, its initiative advances a narrow, protectionist, and neoliberal approach that prioritizes NATO's geopolitical goals over student empowerment.

This should raise red flags for educators, policymakers, and advocates. Media literacy is not a neutral practice. The organizations that design and fund media literacy programs inevitably shape the goals and methods of those programs. When a military alliance like NATO promotes media education, it brings with it a strategic interest in ideological control.

Educators must ask: What kind of media literacy are we teaching—and whose interests does it serve? If the goal is to produce informed, critically thinking citizens capable of questioning power in all its forms, then NATO's approach falls short. Instead of inviting students to explore complex media systems, it simplifies them into a binary struggle between “us” and “them,” encouraging loyalty over literacy.

True media literacy must begin with transparency about who and what is behind the curriculum. It must empower students to question all forms of influence—governmental, corporate, and military alike. And it must resist the creeping presence of militarism in our classrooms. As educators, we must defend the right to question, not just the messages we see, but the institutions that shape them.

This essay was originally published in The Militarization and Weaponization of Media Literacy

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Does the Working Class Need A Party of Its Own?

The Billionaires and Their Minions Have Two Parties.

GARY OLSON

Prospects for a Labor Party

In June 1996, I was one of 1,500 delegates from 80 unions representing half a million workers at the Founding Convention of the Labor Party in Cleveland, Ohio. At the time I was a member of the National Writers Union (NWU, Local 1981, affiliated with the United Auto Workers) and a political science professor at Moravian College in Bethlehem, PA. The primary organizers came out of the Oil, Chemical and Atomic Workers International (OCAW) United Mineworkers, United Electrical, Machinists, California Nurses and the Longshoremens. Tony Mazzocchi (1926–2002) from OCAW was the visionary leader who developed the idea of the Labor Party and set it in motion with the slogan “The Bosses Have Two Parties. We Need One of Our Own.”

A Labor Party had been my dream for over three decades and when the motion to create it was passed unanimously it was one of the emotional high points of my life. I suspect that I was not the only person on the convention floor with tears in my eyes as we sang “Solidarity Forever”.

Neoliberalism, a new generation of union activists and a totally unresponsive Democratic Party (dominated by corporate interests) seemed an opportune moment to create a working class party. I saw the LP as a major vehicle for furthering class consciousness and realizing socialism in the United States.

After the convention, I returned to Bethlehem and together with several other local activists formed the John Brennan Chapter of the Labor Party, named to honor a deceased union official who'd also been a registered socialist. We met monthly and over time managed to sign up some 150 members from across the Lehigh Valley, one of the largest chapters in the country. However, after two more national conventions the LP began to atrophy and ceased to exist in 2006.

Not everyone will agree but for many of us the reason was the failure of national union leaders to provide the financial and organizing resources. Why? Because, when push came to shove, they refused to break with the Democratic Party. Others would suggest that another important piece was that even talk of running candidates was premature. What about today? In a recent piece, Les Leopold asserted “The billionaires have two parties, we need one of our own.” Leopold cited a YouGuv survey of 3,000 voters in the Rust Belt states of Wisconsin, Ohio, Pennsylvania, and Michigan where 57% of respondents “support a new political formation outside the two major parties.” Only 19% opposed it. We know the Democratic brand is toxic and relying on this member of the oligarchical establishment is a fool's errand.

Is investigative historian Eric Zuesse on to something when he [argues](#) that public sentiment for a new third party is at an all-time high and the public's trust in Amer-

ican institutions and, especially the government is at an all-time low? In his recent stunning victory in the Democratic primary for NYC's mayor—and a likely win in the November 4th general election—Democratic socialist Zohran Mamdani ran as fierce opponent of Israel's genocide in Gaza and his campaign stressed “kitchen table” issues, making the city affordable for all its citizens. For example, he promises free childcare, a system to be funded by raising taxes on corporations and the city's richest residents.

In Washington state, Seattle Socialist Kshama Sawant is running against long-time incumbent Democratic Rep. David Smith in the 9th Congressional District. Sawant was on the Seattle City council from 2014 to 2024. Smith is not only a vocal supporter for Israel's genocidal policy but voted for the Iraq war. Sawant is running as an avowed socialist and says that “Smith has blood on his hands.” Sawant calls for a \$25 minimum wage, free universal health care and a halt to US aid to Israel.

What, if anything, can these two contests tell us about the potential for working people to break with the Democratic Party and build a new party for the working class? Are working women and men coming closer to understanding that the capitalist system and its owners are the source of their woes and that both parties are rotten to the core? What is the state of class consciousness today? We might think of class consciousness as nothing less than when the objective, general, and rational interests of a class become its recognized goals. It would read something like the following: “Our collective working class goals cannot be realized without overthrowing the exploitive class relations that prevent us from getting what we want and need.” Some recent studies by D. W. Livingstone suggest that on the one hand, less than 10% of workers possess a well-developed revolutionary class consciousness. On the other hand, we know that these are often the core activists in social movements.

What's Next? Is Democratic Socialist Zohran Mamdani's Run for Mayor of New York City Part of the Answer?

Democratic Socialist Zohran Mamdani is the Democratic nominee for Mayor of New York and running on the Democratic line. He won a decisive victory in the Democratic primary election in June 2025, defeating former Gov. Andrew “ass grabber” Cuomo and nine other candidates. Mamdani received 56% of the vote. In the Nov. 4 general election, Cuomo is running on the independent “Fight and Deliver” ballot line. Eric Adams, the incumbent mayor is running on the self-designated “End AntiSemitism” line in a pitiful maneuver to win the Zionist vote. NYC's rapacious ruling elite is terrified (ditto, the national Democratic Party) by the prospect of a Mamdani victory but NYC's CEOs are split on their favored candidate. Even the hapless, reviled, and thoroughly corrupt Adams has raised \$1.5 million from the uber rich since June 10. Major union leaders had endorsed Cuomo, but most have now come around to backing Mamdani, perhaps in an effort to catch up with their membership. Think here of how every major union refused to offer financial and organizing resources to the Labor Party in 1997–8.

It's worth noting that NYC is the richest city in the United States. It has 66 billionaires and 384,000 millionaires. It's also one of the ten poorest cities in the country. Incidentally, if elected, Mamdani wouldn't be the first socialist elected to office

in the city. Vito Marcantonio, a friend of W.E.B. Du Bois and Paul Robeson, represented Harlem in Congress from 1935–1950. Benjamin Davis, an African American, represented Harlem on New York's City Council from 1944–1949 before being convicted under the Smith Act for his association with the Communist Party and served over three years in prison. Robeson publicly spoke out for Davis.

Mamdani won by attracting different ethnic groups, young New Yorkers, (average age in NYC is 38) and previous nonvoters. There were 30,000 enthusiastic volunteers who knocked on 1.6 million doors across the city and Mamdani amassed 4.5 million followers on social media. Mamdani's campaign was all about “kitchen table” issues that could make NYC livable again—in other words, basic shit. The vibe I'm hearing is, “This guy actually likes the city.” He's establishing a link with people and conveys a sense of solidarity and empathy. His proposals include rent control, free mass transit, “no cost” municipal day-care and elder-care, raising the minimum wage to \$30 an hour and one city-owned super market in each borough to keep prices down. Economist Richard Wolff notes that if he chose to use them, New York City's mayor has vast powers. For example, he could use eminent domain to build high quality low-cost housing on existing golf courses and seized empty buildings, city-financed summer camps for kids and much more. His programs will be financed by taxing corporations and a 2% tax on individuals with an income exceeding one million dollars. Adding to his appeal is that Mamdani is a longtime, vocal supporter of Palestinian rights, promised to restrict funding to any charity that supports Israeli settlements and will arrest Benjamin Netanyahu if he ever sets foot in the city, in accordance with the International Criminal Court rulings on Israeli genocide in Gaza.

When asked if he liked capitalism, Mamdani said “No. I have many critiques of capitalism. Dr. King said, ‘Call it democracy or call it democratic socialism; there must be a better distribution of wealth for all of God's children in this country.’ That's what I'm focused on: dignity and taking on income inequality.” (CNN interview)

Elsewhere, I have cited socialist Kshama Sawant's campaign, “Workers Strike Back,” against the longtime Democratic Congressperson David Smith. The latter's largest donor is AIPAC and Palantir's Alex Karp is a major supporter. Smith has said that the extreme “left policies” of the Democrats are the reason they lost the 2024 race to Trump. As the ranking Democrat on the Foreign Affairs Committee, he's totally behind Israel's genocide in Gaza, voted for the Iraq War and been a corporate tool over his entire tenure.

Sawant has said that Mamdani's race is very important and, overall, a good thing that a socialist may become the mayor of New York. However, if I understand her, she is convinced that if NYC's billionaires had to have a socialist mayor it would be someone who ran as a Democrat. Why? Because it might increase the chances of domesticating him/her/they as a sheep herder for the Democratic Party in the mode of AOC or Bernie. (I confess that Bernie fooled me the first time.)

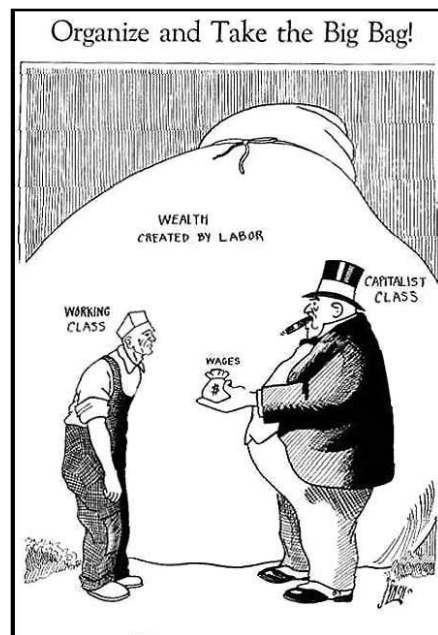
Mamdani asserts that, “There is a battle for the soul of the Democratic Party.” Sawant argues that “The soul of the Democratic Party is evil. Look at 2024. They would rather let Trump win than allow a working class agenda to win.” I agree. I mean, what the f@*k. They wouldn't run a candidate who pledged to end military funding for Israel on her first day in office... an absolute red line for many of us. My own view is that

the Democrats have contempt for ordinary people and their views. They are entirely beholden to their corporate donors and the capitalist system they uphold.

We don't know what Mamdani will do if he's elected. He has said "I want to represent all New Yorkers", but of course that's impossible. Perhaps it's only political rhetoric but it does obscure the essence of class struggle. That is, no matter how "nice" and approachable Mamdani seems, the ruling class will pull out all the stops to crush him. Sawant had said, "If elected, I won't represent Microsoft or Amazon." In doing so, she's drawing attention to class struggle and how Democrats end up selling out the working class. She contends that politics is everything and given that, what strategy is one going to adopt. So far, Sawant has received contributions from 43 states.

My sense is that Mamdani's campaign might foster a predisposition or preconsciousness toward a more robust socialism, toward class consciousness and away from the two-party system, especially among younger folks who are less fixed in their ways. If I lived in NYC, I'd vote for him but with keeping all the above in mind.

Gary Olson is Professor Emeritus of Political Science at Moravian University in Bethlehem, PA; his books include U.S. Foreign Policy and the Third World Peasant (1974), The Other Europe (1977), How the World Works (1981) and Empathy Imperiled: Capitalism, Culture and the Brain (2013).



Public Schools, Climate Disasters, Workers' Control

DON FITZ



St. Louis tornado damage

When teachers' union president Ray Cummings told the superintendent that her plan could put students in danger, he brought together problems of excluding workers from critical decisions and schemes to use climate disasters to privatize public schools.

On May 16, 2025, a tornado tore through predominantly-Black north St. Louis, killing 5, and leaving thousands of homes, businesses, and schools either destroyed or with [roofs ripped off](#). A month later, many buildings still had blue tarps covering them as the only way to protect them from the hot summer downpours.

Without consulting the teachers' union, School Superintendent Millicent Borishade outlined a policy to relocate from seven damaged buildings to other schools, which were selected based on "bell schedules, proximity from the original schools, space utilization, athletics, and principal input."

Upon learning of the proposal, Ray Cummings, president of the American Federation of Teachers (AFT) Local 420 in St. Louis, wrote to the superintendent that it could result in serious conflicts between students.

He explained that there is often mistrust between students from different neighborhoods. Cummings warned that violence could easily erupt when such groups are crowded together.

Missouri AFT President Carron "CJ" Johnson told me during an interview that she agreed with Cummings that Borishade's proposal "threatens to create unsafe conditions by consolidating students from different areas into overcrowded, unfamiliar environments, heightening tensions and security risks to those who may not be wearing the right color shoes for that neighborhood." She also emphasized that St. Louis already has problems with school buses and that the administration should not exacerbate the transportation situation.

But the superintendent's plan would crowd Yeatman-Liddell Middle School into Gateway Middle, which has a capacity of 658 students. Their combined total would be 737 students. Johnson pointed out that "Dunbar Middle School never should have been closed, and if it could be reopened, it could accommodate students from Yeatman-Liddell or any other school that would be able to enter it."

The capacity of Miller Career Academy is 1013 students. A similarly dubious aspect of the superintendent's measure would be transferring students from two damaged schools to Miller, which would bring its enrollment to 1,253.

Superintendent Borishade relocated from Seattle to St. Louis in 2023. AFT's president, Johnson, said that the superintendent "is not in tune with students, families, or workers. She is not listening to people on the ground. She is not changing her narrative to fit with the people of St. Louis."

One of the major concerns for Cummings and Johnson, as well as other union members and parents, is that schools severely affected by the May 2025 tornado may never reopen and that the buildings could be sold to charter school operators. For years, pro-privatization groups, such as the "Opportunity Trust," have provided funding to those advocating for charter schools in St. Louis. They try, and often succeed, in electing candidates to the St. Louis Board of Education who typically advocate closing as many public schools as possible. Others run for the School Board to win approval for their own charter school.

Privatizers push hard to open charter schools in Black neighborhoods, claiming that Black parents must choose charter schools if they want their children to learn how to read. The two great ironies of this argument are that (a) those advocating such charter school schemes are typically white and (b) there is no evidence that Black children who attend Missouri charters have better reading scores than those in public schools.

Critics have documented that charter schools represent a range of threats to public education. Charters typically do not require professional and non-professional staff to hold the same level of degrees and qualifications as those in public schools. As a result, they offer lower pay and fewer benefits to staff, which may lead to higher turnover and less student engagement.

Charters often offer fewer academic hours and extra-curricular activities than public schools. They can "cream" students, meaning that they only admit students with the best academic records or fewest behavioral problems. Even if they do not "cream", they are very likely to "dump" problem students back to public schools.

Charter schools may not test the proficiency of students in the same way public schools do, making it harder to evaluate their claims of success. Above all, decision-making processes for charters are not conducted by publicly elected boards, meaning that parents and others may have little to no influence over governing bodies set up to increase corporate profits.

When Hurricane Katrina slammed New Orleans in 2005, privatizers smelled a gold mine. The May 7, 2025, webinar, titled "[Defending Public Education](#)," was co-hosted by the Green Party of St. Louis and AFT Local 420. Dave Cash, President of the United Teachers of New Orleans, described how the "near total privatization of New Orleans public schools had devastating consequences for communities, teaching staff and students."

Like St. Louis, New Orleans teachers have had a hard time getting decision-makers to listen to them, a task made more challenging to those organizing a union when the privatizers are motivated by profit rather than concern with education. Like New Orleans, those in St. Louis are worried that those interested in undermining public education will let no catastrophe be overlooked as an opportunity to destroy what should be our right as citizens. As climate-related crises escalate, so will opportunities to dismantle public services.

The problem of top administrators ignoring sound advice from those who carry out daily tasks raises the long-standing question of "workers' control." Should unions limit themselves to "bread and butter" issues like pay, benefits, sick leave, and vacation? Or, should unions seek more control over employees' work lives and decision-making power? It is a core question of whether working people should accept their roles as mere cogs in the wheel of production or seek to humanize labor by defining their own jobs.

One of the best-known current advocates of workers' control is Michael Albert, who originated the idea of "participatory economics" or "[parecon](#)." Albert emphasizes ways tasks can be shared so that there are "more and more people having a more and more appropriate [level of say](#) over their own lives."

Historically, the concept of workers' control has been emphasized as a safety and health issue. People working in factories are concerned about injuries resulting from the unsafe use of tools or speed-up, which can cause accidents and injuries. However, now that a considerable number of union members are in professional jobs, workers' control extends to issues such as stress, treatment by administrators, and how work impacts the public, including students who may be endangered by poorly thought-out policies that could lead to increased clashes at school.

The dispute over what should be done for St. Louis schools following the climate disaster has more profound ramifications than might meet the eye. More than just asking how students should be relocated after the 2025 tornado, it brings up the question of how decisions should be made. Teachers know students' strengths and weaknesses because they are in touch with them daily. It may not be enough to say school bureaucrats must listen to teachers. Is it time to establish veto power for elected worker representatives who are themselves directly affected by decisions and represent others who are similarly affected?

Don Fitz (fitzdon@aol.com) has taught Environmental Psychology at Washington University and is the author of Cuban Health Care: The Ongoing Revolution (2020). He is Outreach Coordinator for the Green Party of St. Louis and on the Editorial Board of [Green Social Thought](#), where this article [first appeared](#).

Alligator Alcatraz

JOHN JIAMBALVO

Hail America, bright city on a hill,
Exemplar to the world of self-deception
Hail to the proud ingenuity
Of your unspeakable cruelty
Packaged as a mode of self-defense.

You have reinvented concentration camps
And made them great again for persecution.
The worst of the worst who work in crummy jobs
Can now expect to spend their wretched days
In chain-link cages fit for mangy dogs.

The land of the free imprisons more folks
Than any other land. Stalin, you're old news.
A new Chief Criminal has taken charge.
All you Ku Klux Klaners, he has surpassed
Your nightmare dreams for people black and brown.

The government can arrest and put away
Any immigrant or those who look the part
On any pretense. No need to follow law.
Its forces are a law unto themselves
And their power is spreading. No one is safe.

Alligators and pythons will guard the gates.
When the floods and hurricanes arrive
They can float inside and have a snack
On some immigrant who sought a better life
And became an entrée for things that bite.

Our leader wants a Nobel Prize for Peace.
He's going to get the Abu Ghraib Prize
For cruelty done in the name of sport.
May he enjoy round after round of golf
Until a gator finds him near its pond.

John Jiambalvo is the author of two collections of poetry, Shadows Walking Among Questions and Americana Collection. He is also the author of a satirical political novel, Smirk.

A Dawn that Must Break in the Face of the Western Dusk

EMILIANO LÓPEZ



Xul Solar (Argentina), Drago, 1927.

Last May 9, Moscow prepared to commemorate the 80th anniversary of the heroic victory of the Red Army over Nazism. Beyond the historical importance, the most interesting spice for the current times was the political unity shown in this event by the governments of China and Russia, with a strongly critical stance towards the West and by recovering a common history and narrative for the construction of a new world based on the defeat of that barbaric project. The presence of Presidents Lula Da Silva, Nicolás Maduro, Miguel Díaz-Canel, and other leaders from different regions completed the outlook of what is just a sample of the acceleration of historical times in the transition of global hegemony.

It is precisely the commitment to multipolarity by the peoples of the Global South through sovereign political projects that is accelerating the transition. Although the process of change in the global order has been going on for several decades, in recent months, the pace of change has been dizzying for several reasons. First of all, the economic decline of the West does not seem to have a solution. Donald Trump's tariff policy is not having the expected results. U.S. industry is subject to the rule of finance and the Silicon Valley Consensus. This leads to a constant attempt to revitalize the economy through speculative bubbles, following the suggestions once put forward by Alan Greenspan. Thus, in terms of production, the West has nothing to offer. The BRICS+ group of countries today produces 40% of the world's product and includes 45% of the world's population. Moreover, the BRICS+ trade, infrastructure, investment, and

financial agreements with other countries in the Global South involve almost all of the world's raw material and food-producing regions. Therefore, in the face of a Global South centered in the East with a productive and inclusive means of development, the West continues to bet on financialization that only offers the peoples of the South the precariousness of life, scarcity of goods, instability, and shameful inequality.



Ebony G. Patterson (Jamaica), *...they stood in a time of unknowing... for those who bear/bare witness, 2017.*

Secondly, we are witnessing a moment of accelerated dissolution of the Western cultural project. The enlightenment that accompanied the birth of the Western capitalist project gave way to anti-scientific societal projects, based on apathy or fanaticism of various kinds. The West seems to oscillate between zombie neoliberalism and the construction of dismembered societies, with a sharp break of the social bond. In light of this, people suffer constant frustration as the only result of living in societies that do not contain them. In the face of this dehumanizing project, the Global South shows paths of hope based on the articulation of human knowledge and technology, economic modernization with humanity at the center and political cooperation for peace in the face of the growing and unabashed belligerence of NATO, as we laid out precisely in our last [Dossier in collaboration with the Zetkin Forum](#).

Undoubtedly, the consolidation and expansion of the BRICS+ (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, and the United Arab Emirates) is a central phenomenon in this acceleration of the ongoing reconfiguration of the world order. Because we will not cease to repeat it, multipolarity is a project for which the peoples of the Global South must fight and not a stage already reached. This political and economic articulation of the BRICS+, especially from the agenda set out in Kazan, as [Isabel Rauber](#) has developed it, better conditions emerge for the Global South as a whole to carry forward an agenda of sovereign development, with economic cooperation that allows breaking the links of historical dependence with the Global North that have been expressed through unequal exchange, capital flight, dependence on foreign capital and the super-exploitation of labor to ensure the operation of the expansionary machine of global imperialism.

Taller 4 Rojo (Colombia), *Vietnam o agresión del imperialismo a los pueblos* [Vietnam or Imperialism's Aggression Against the People], 1972.



Let's take some aspects of BRICS+ that help think about the construction of the multipolar project for the Global South (see our [Dossier 78](#)).

Today, as we have said, most global trade takes place on the South-South axis. Although China's trade with Europe and the United States continues to be important, these percentages are decreasing year by year. That is why a central topic of ongoing discussion, central at the recent BRICS+ meeting in Kazan, is the possibility to displace the dollar in trade among Global South countries. This is a very important bet and responds not only to a political need but also to a material reality: the world reference currency cannot be the currency of a country that is not the most productive in global terms and, at the same time, does not alone represent most of the global trade volume. This discussion has been developed in detail in the second volume of [Wenhua Zongheng](#) (文化纵横). Discussed here are the possibility of a common BRICS+ currency and the formation of a basket of currencies, among other alternatives. The best strategy for implementing a change in the financial architecture and replacing the dollar is still a debate, but acceleration is also seen at this point with China rapidly and steadily divesting from U.S. Treasury bonds. De-dollarization opens very important possibilities for the Global South and, in particular, for Latin America where dependence is expressed in the constant need to "produce" dollars to stabilize national economies. This only leads to over-indebtedness, of which the most embarrassing example is the Argentine government of Javier Milei.

For its part, an important debate is how to finance human-centered, sovereign development strategies. In this dimension, BRICS's New Development Bank (NDB) established in 2015 is one of the institutions of greatest concrete importance when thinking about the contribution that this grouping of Global South economies provides. While the International Monetary Fund and the World Bank play at being the guarantors of the Western financialization process, the NDB has already developed infrastructure and sustainable development projects for more than 30 billion dollars. What is most interesting is that this institution sets among its priorities and

strategic tasks the financing in the Global South of projects in Transportation Infrastructure; Clean Energy and Energy Efficiency; Water and Sanitation; Environmental Protection; Digital Infrastructure; Local Currency Financing and Emergency Response. These elements mark an abysmal distance from the objectives of the IMF as a guarantor of the austerity and poverty strategy for the peoples of the South. In addition, the appointment of former President Dilma Rousseff's presidency of this organization in 2023 is undoubtedly excellent news for our region. Of course, the agenda and initiatives must be built by our peoples and their governments, since it is not necessarily a natural consequence that the presence of a financing institution produces a structural change.



Nazca Lines (Peru), Knife-wielding Orca, 22 meters, geoglyph. Yamagata University Institute of Nasca. Discovered with drones and AI.

The last aspect we would like to point out is the technological one. Today, the challenge to U.S. hegemony and the acceleration of the transition occurs because the BRICS+ countries, particularly China, have the capacity to compete with the West on the technological frontier. To a large extent, there are areas such as the entire chain of renewable energies where competition is effectively impossible for the West. In an interesting text, **Gabriel Merino**, a researcher and friend of our institute, develops how the BRICS+, with China at the forefront, have redefined the dispute for the control of cutting-edge technologies. The process of techno-productive change being carried out by this group of countries allows for progress in Technology Transfer and Development, offering alternatives to Western technological monopolies. As for Digital Infrastructure and Connectivity, especially with China's investment through initiatives such as the Belt and Road, it contributes to closing the digital divide in many regions of the Global South. Finally, there is a challenge to hegemonic intellectual property, given that the "political insubordination" of the BRICS+ is in search for models of innovation and access to technology that are not completely subject to the intellectual property logics of the Global North. This is a very interesting aspect to deepen our South-South cooperation agendas.

For these reasons, for Latin America and the Global South as a whole, the multipolar world project has in BRICS+ a player of main importance. As we pointed out in Dossier 51, multipolarity appears as an opportunity for the region. The decline of U.S. hegemony and the presence of a group of countries that pose a real alternative to Western barbarism open new possibilities to rediscuss our sovereign development agenda once and for all.

This essay first appeared on the Nuestra America Office of Tricontinental: Institute for Social Research (<https://thetricontinental.org/>) on 25 June 2025.

Emiliano López is a militant, researcher, and professor. Since 2004, he has been active in various political movements and spaces linked to labor organizing and political education within popular movements.

"The future of labor is the future of America."

John L. Lewis

Did New Yorkers say, No Mo Cuomo; No Mo Turkey Trot with Papa Cop?

RAYMOND NAT TURNER

Did New Yorkers say, No Mo Cuomo;
No Mo Turkey Trot with Papa Cop?
Did they say they can See something and
Say something brighter's on the horizon?

Did New Yorkers say, "Change not spare change?"
Did they say it's way past time for Go-Go hammers? Way past time
For symphonies of whining saws? Way past time for sawdust storms — Getting
Amish — 'bout raising thousands of rent-stabilized roofs?

Did New Yorkers say they want their subway station at St. Nic/145th
Sparkling and clean? Even pristine? With upper westside pride? With
1-10-Cathedral-Parkway/Frederick Douglass facelift? Bright rainbow mosaic
Of tiles: likeness of Melissa Freeman, MD — Where A, B, C, D run FREE?

Did New Yorkers say, they don't need a 35,000 strong conquering
Army under Papa Cop tutelage, plastic cuffing peace marches?
Reigning baton blows on Black Lives Matter? Teaching Columbia, City
College, NYU, New School students and professors pain compliance?

Did New Yorkers say that neither disgraced donkey speaks to The
Peoples' needs? Like the warfare state that only bombs and bleeds?
Did they say No Mo toxic cultures of fear and intimidation? No Mo
Conflicts of interest and mis-administration?

Did they say, No Mo Cuomo? No Mo Turkey Trot with Papa Cop?
No Mo deputy devils quoting scripture from their deep-pocketed
Puppet-masters' Bible? No Mo romance with their worn, torn and
Ragged 1% playbook?

Did New Yorkers say, No Mo Cuomo? No Mo Turkey Trot with Papa
Cop? No Mo mischief and bullying with politicians moneybags' backing?
Did they say, "Now's The Time:" to send both Papa Cop and Cuomo packing?
Did they say, "Now's The Time:" ... to demand the 'impossible'?

*Former forklift driver/warehouse worker/janitor, Raymond Nat Turner is a NYC poet; BAR's
Poet-in-Residence; and founder/co-leader of the jazz-poetry ensemble UpSurge!NYC. [Read
other articles by Raymond Nat](#), or [visit Raymond Nat's website](#).*

One Big Beautiful Bank Job!

RAYMOND NAT TURNER

Masked. Armed to the teeth. Synchronized
Rolexes. They left Lamborghini and Maserati
Motors purring ... softly in the shadows on
Capitalist Hill

And then — suddenly — in sonic boom unison they
Shouted at The People:
UP AGAINST THE WALL — MUTHAFUKKKAS!
GET 'EM UP! THIS IS A FUCKIN STICKUP!

Yo, fatso! Yeah, you. Waddle your way over to Senator
Sadist. You, on the crutches; swing over to Congressman
Cruel. Move it! Don't make me bust a cap in your poor
Ol' tired cripple ass! Did it in Afghanistan. Did it in Iraq.

Outta that wheelchair and on the floor, Pops!
And, while you're at it, gimme me those teeth.
Move it! Quick, fork over the hospice money.
Chop-chop, drop life expectancies in Golden Dome!

Hey, Bag Lady, drop those damn vouchers in the
Billionaire bag over there! Yo, Sambo! Down on the
Ground! Keep your fuckin mouth shut and no one will get
Hurt ... Well, at least until ... after we make our get away

Hey, Granny, gimme those meds!
Hand over the Medicaid, ol' maid.
Listen up, kids! Drop those school lunches in the
Billionaire bag. Yo, Teach, handover Head Start!

OK — simple-minded sukkkas — quick, up on your feet!
We're breaking you for the billionaires; and Boss Tweet — Robbing and plun-
dering you, for the Murderous 1% Mob
Pulling off — yet another — **One Big Beautiful Bank Job!**

*Former forklift driver/warehouse worker/janitor, Raymond Nat Turner is a NYC poet; BAR's
Poet-in-Residence; and founder/co-leader of the jazz-poetry ensemble UpSurge!NYC. [Read
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Notes From the Editor (continued from inside front cover)

It's unlikely because too many powerful people are involved but let's hope the dam breaks on Epstein's Black Book, and we find out the truth about what's been correctly described as a "giant child rapist ring." The Epstein imbroglio exemplifies everything wrong in this country.

Maintaining victim privacy is given as the reason for not disclosing the files but that only guarantees that elite connections will never be disclosed. So, what began as a possible exposure of the Deep State now seems to be insulating it. Was Epstein acting as an operative of Israeli intelligence as alleged by Tucker Carlson? Perhaps Trump's latest betrayal of his base will keep this matter in the public eye and shake something loose.

Trump has called the entire matter a "hoax and a scam" started by Democrats and called his "PAST" supporters who believe it, "stupid people." Chris Hedges has listed the names of all those we know were involved in one way or another, but much remains hidden. (See Chris Hedges "Trump, Epstein and the Deep State", page 39.)

On Ukraine, Trump is providing Ukraine with new Patriot systems and missiles that can penetrate deep into Russia, including Moscow. He said that Europe will purchase the weapons from the US which will generate "billions" for defense contractors, perhaps trying to assuage the anger within his MAGA base for this slap in the face. Trump also threatened new tariffs on Russia in 50 days if Putin did not agree to a peace deal. My sense is that Trump's frustration, boasting, temper tantrums, bluffing and empty threats will not change the outcome of the war in the slightest as Russia's summer offensive grinds forward, capturing several villages per day. This is a war of attrition and with its vastly superior numbers, Russia is going to prevail. Secondary sanctions? These are penalties other countries — like China and India — would supposedly pay if they continue trading with Russia. They will respond, "Take a hike, Don." Further, these sanctions would devastate the global economy and come back to haunt the US economy. Trump has no leverage and will have even less in 50 days. At this point I doubt whether the Kremlin even pays much attention to Trump's outbursts.

Some Republicans are turning themselves into human pretzels as they attempt to remain true to Trump. Here are just a few examples.

Rep. Derrick Van Orden from Wisconsin said in March, "We must stop these endless wars." Yesterday: "I trust the peacemaker in chief. I trust him. He has my absolute, unequivocal, support."

Rep. Troy Nehls of Texas, argued for withdrawal of all military support for Ukraine. Yesterday: "Donald is the only guy who can stop this."

Rep. Warran Davidson from Ohio staunchly opposed funding for Ukraine: Yesterday: "The president really gets it right. This is not our war."

Vice-President J.D. Vance was a fierce opponent of US involvement and at the Quincy Institute (February 2022) said "I gotta be honest with you. I don't really care what happens to Ukraine, one way or another." Now we see him sitting silently next to Trump as the president promises more aid.

Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene from Georgia is an exception. She has consistently said that Trump is betraying his promise to end US involvement in foreign wars.

Note: In truth, what Trump announced is really only a symbolic move, a mouse fart, that will accomplish nothing on the ground. His words were uttered on behalf of conning MAGAS. Why? Because he can't tell them that "endless wars" are required for the US to rule the world.

The only thing that might possibly help Ukraine is the infusion of large numbers of highly trained reserves, but Ukraine simply doesn't have them. As Scott Ritter says, "Ukraine is a hospice patient waiting to die."

Dr. Victoria Rose, a senior plastic surgeon from Britain, has finished a three week stint volunteering at Nasser Hospital in southern Gaza. She treats 10 patients per day



on average, 60 percent of them under the age of 15. Unlike two previous visits where shrapnel and burns were prominent, this time "children are coming in with knees missing and feet missing and hands missing." Israel has barred all foreign journalists from Gaza and as a result, Dr. Rose has been sending regular videos on Instagram and said, "I thought people needed to see what I was seeing." (NYT, July 11, 2025)

Meanwhile, in the illegally occupied West Bank, Sayfallah Masallet, a 23-year-old dual US-Palestinian citizen was beaten to death by settlers while visiting relatives. A second man, 23-year-old Mohammed Shahabi was fatally shot to death by settlers.

On "Invincible" Israel as a Sanctuary State for Jews

The Israelis were able to get in a sucker punch on Iran but after 12 days were being pounded by Iranian missiles and were forced to cry "Uncle Sam" for help. Had the war gone on another 12 days, it would have been lights out for Tel Aviv and Israel would have been flattened. One of the repercussions is the "Invincible Israel" myth is over. Another, and closely related one, is that it may no longer be possible for Jews to view Israel as their "Sanctuary State."

From 1948 onward, the colonial settler entity billed itself as a "safe haven" for Jews. This is difficult to maintain if the Mediterranean Sea becomes the "refuge route" used by Israeli yacht owners leaving Haifa for Cyprus and individuals who are able to do so, fly off to New Jersey.

According to Israel's Central Bureau of Statistics, the number of individuals leaving Israel was already significantly higher in 2024 than previous years and there's every reason to expect a sharp increase after the 12-day War. They're leaving because they no longer believe the Jewish state can protect them. (A record number have sought

citizenship in Germany.) Further, this is a class issue as security is a privilege allotted to well-off people. According to Henley and Partners, some 350 millionaires are expected to leave Israel in 2025. This is accompanied by a “soft drain” of professionals, including academics, seeking better opportunities abroad. Even the *New York Times* concluded a recent piece (7/11/2025) with the words “Israel is less safe than ever.” As political analyst Don Hanks asks, “What happens to the idea of statehood when Jews no longer feel safe?”

Finally, retired US Foreign Service Office Christopher Datta [writing](#) in the mainstream journal *American Diplomacy* offers the following data: There are 2,089,000 Palestinians in Israel, 7,427,000 Jews, and 564,000 non-Arab Christian and others. With the annexation of the West Bank, the Arab population grows to almost 5 million. If one includes Gaza, the Arab population almost equals the Jewish one. Further, the annual growth rate of Muslims is 2.0% and the Jewish rate is 1.8%.

Datta has had recent conversations with West Bank settlers in which they told him that Palestinians in Israel should all be pushed into Jordan “or else kill them.” The settlers offered effusive praise for Baruch Goldstein who, in 1994, attacked the Ibrahim Mosque in Hebron, killing 25, including children. The settlers said that Goldstein was their “hero”, and they wanted to erect a shrine to him.

Given the demographics, history of violence and hatred, and total absence of “enlightened leadership” in both Israel and US, Datta predicts “one of the greatest catastrophes in human history.” In Datta’s view, Netanyahu’s policies have condemned the Jewish state to “eventual collapse...a trajectory that it cannot survive in the long run.”

Datta errs in only blaming Netanyahu; he’s blind to the origins of Israel as a colonial settler state and his primary concern is what his dismal projected future for Israel portends for US policy in West Asia.

In a piece titled “Growing Up Class-Conscious,” Howard Zinn (1922–2010) recounts being a 17-year-old and attending a large, non-violent demonstration in Times Square. Suddenly, seemingly out of nowhere, hundreds of police charged into the crowd and began smashing people with their clubs. Zinn was knocked unconscious, and when he awoke a half an hour later, he realized that the “state and its police were not neutral referees in a society of contending ideas. They were on the side of the rich and powerful.”

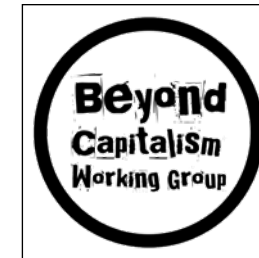
He recounts, “I was no longer a liberal, a believer in the self-correcting character of American democracy. I was a radical, believing that something fundamental was wrong in this country — not just the existence of poverty amidst great wealth, not just the treatment of black people, but something rotten at the root. The situation required not just a new president, or new laws, but an uprooting of the old order, the introduction of a new kind of society — cooperation, peaceful and egalitarian.”

Zinn continues by stating, “Perhaps I am exaggerating the importance of that one moment, but I think not. I have to believe that our lives can be turned in a different direction, our minds adopt a different way of thinking, by some significant, though small, event. That belief can be frightening or exhilarating, depending on whether you just contemplate it or do something about it.”

Are there events going on today that can accelerate class-consciousness via a vicarious blow to the head? Experiences or a succession of experiences that impart an incontrovertible moral clarity that makes it impossible ever again to see the world in the same way.

Join us via Zoom 7:00–9:00 PM on Fridays
for political discussions and Thursdays to watch
and discuss significant films and politics.

(Zoom link moravian.zoom.us/j/8075321907)



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FUELING GENOCIDE

INSIDE THE GLOBAL SUPPLY CHAIN THAT DELIVERS JET FUEL TO ISRAEL'S MILITARY

Israel purchases fuel for its military fighter jets with U.S. funds. This fuel, produced by the U.S. energy company **Valero**, is shipped on commercial tanker ships owned by the company **Saltchuk**. Each ship receives **\$6 million in subsidies** through the **U.S. Tanker Security Program**. Recent contract data shows that the **U.S. is increasing delivery of jet fuel** to Israel to support attacks in Palestine, Lebanon, Yemen, Syria, and Iran.



1 IN THE U.S.

In Corpus Christi, Texas, **JP-8 military jet fuel** is loaded onto one of two tanker ships, the **Overseas Santorini** or the **Overseas Sun Coast**.

2 IN THE MEDITERRANEAN

RESUPPLY PORTS

These tanker ships regularly stop to take on fuel and supplies at **Mediterranean ports**.

ENABLING GENOCIDE

Legal experts agree that states and companies facilitating these shipments are **complicit in Israel's genocide**.

GOING DARK

Tanker ships carrying Israeli military jet fuel have obscured their voyage details and **turned off tracking devices when approaching Israel**.



TAKING ACTION TO BLOCK THE BOATS

In July 2024, **dockworkers, civil society groups, and social movements** working together forced one tanker ship, the **Overseas Santorini**, to **abandon its planned stops in Spain and Gibraltar**.

NO SAFE HARBOR

Activists mobilized to deny the ship access to other ports along its route to Israel, including in **Malta, Crete and Cyprus**.

SECRET DELIVERY

The ship **evaded activists by turning off its tracking system** before delivering the **deadly cargo** to Israel.

“The level and speed of... [destruction in Gaza has] not been seen in any other conflict in the 21st century

Amnesty International

3 IN GAZA

One shipment can fuel about

12,000 flights

by Israel's **F-16 and F-35 fighter jets**, which are used to drop bombs on entire families of Palestinians in Gaza.